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## UNIT 1: THE LINGUIST BY GEETASHREE CHATTERJEE

Q1. Write in detail about Geetashree Chatterjee.

Ans Geetashree chatterjee is an upcoming writer and her stories have not gained popularity . she is a short story writer who writes dourn her feelings urithot any qualms , which make them rendering . apart from writing short stories ,chatterjee writes revew blogs, commentaries and poems. her blogs " panacee and speak your heart out are storehrise of her works .she had also written stories like maamone and illusion.

Geetashree chatterjee was born in Kolkata , west Bengal , brought up in delhi, she is a graduate from delhi university .she also holds a diploma in personality management industrial relations. she has worked with the petroleum se natural gas sector for 22 years .she loves listening to Hindustani classical music , painting are dancing. so for chatterhee has given the impreseon that she is instrested reading only some particular topics and subjeets but like reding , eriting was never on her mind . it was not even a hobby or least a passion . however ,it suddenly happened to her . she just began to express her feeling and experiences on paper . through she has always been intrigued by the beauty of language be it . English Bengali , or hindi writing was not on the cards . however ,it began probably as a sort of replacement therepy for music.

Gradually , chatterjee's heart estab lished an intimate connection with poetry. she loves to speak about common , people , usually overlooked or ignored by many writes . she describes herself as nobody struggling to find an identity among the worthy .she believer that someday .she would and etch the everyday chaos that is also an individual part of her. some of her writing are, casket of love ,the imposker, I wish I could be ypur beau that give fome to chatterjee.

Q2. Write a note on upcoming writers in India.

Ans Indian `literature is renowned througharit the world for its complexity and depth, with the range of fecting the incredible diversrty of india itself . few upcoming writers of india are discussed blow neset who are retracing the boundaries of india literature and engaging with the forces of globalization and modernitywhich are reshaping their country . first one is chatterjee, who is an upcoming writer and her stories popularity . chatterjee born in Kolkata, west Bengal , is a short story writer who writes down her feeling without any qualms which make them , heart rendering . apart from writers , blogs commentaries and speak your heart out are storehouse of her works . she has also written stories like maamone and illusion. The next in the india writer and journalist whose first novel the white tiger / won the 2008 man booker prize , aravid adiga is at the forefront of the new generation of young literary talents in india. born in Chennai in 1947 , adiga began his career as a journalist before deciding to focus on writing fiction a decision which park off rapidly with the massive acclaim garnered by the white tiger .

Moving forurard an established poet who only recently turned his hand to prose his debut novel was " narcopolis . thayil based much of his novel on his experience. kiran desai is one of the most highly acclaimed Indian writers of her generation despite only releasing two novels thus for in her coreer she is settled in USAnow .her first novel , hullabaler in the guava, orchard , won widespread praise for its sensitive portrayal of rural life in india .her second novel " the inheritance of loss. won the man booker prize in 2006 last writer in the list is an Indian American auther jhumpa cahiri became one of the most prominent writer in recent years . she won pulitizer prize for fiction in 2006 for her deput short storings collection interpreter of maladies .



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Q3. Analyse the story *The Linguist.*

Ans The story is about two friends, their friendship, jealousy, freedom and happiness. Nalini and the narrator are good friends and share common interest for literature. When the narrator is told that Nalini is getting married to a linguist professor living in abroad, she was jealous. Soon that day came when Nalini left the country to live with her intellectual husband abroad. Here the narrator got busy with her job and several years passed. One day both friends meet at a get together and the narrator becomes aware of Nalini's troubled married life. The narrator is quite amused to know that Nalini had to deal with the high expectations of being a linguist's wife. She realised may be Nalini's life was not all rosy abroad. However, the story ends when the friends meet accidently in CP, Delhi.

Q4. Do you think that Nalini did the right thing in coming back to India? Explain.

Ans Nalini , friend of author , was a married to a linguist , who was a professor of comparative study of languages and working at one of the widely known international academic centres . she went abroad with her husband to live . nalinis marriage seemed to be on the rocks . apparently , married to a linguist had its own share of strain . nalini's husband nurtured a selective society of fellow linguists who had this strange habit of communicating in multiple languages. naturally, nalini found it difficult to keep peace with them . at times she felt like an outsider and at other times , she was made to feel like one. she tried to disscuss the matter with her husband however , he only had a quiet co0ntempt for an answer. graduallydiffeidence set in . nalini felt as thought she wear good for nothing and reteated into a shell, which made things worse somebody suggested a change of scene. so she visited to the homeland all by her self . although shamlee had grave doubts whether this self imposed separation would ultimately prove fruitful but in my perception this change prouded herlittle relief from the tention she was facing with her husband abroad. in this way she could remove her warries by discussing them with her dear once. as it was the place where she was born and raised and she had a lots of friends or relative and in her husband country she didn't have any friend to talk with so she was feeling little better during her visit to india. it was good to see theold nalini backagoing .

Q5. What are the reasons Nalini's fairy tale marriage with the linguist do not succeed? Elaborate.

Ans Nalini writers friends was married to a linguist who was working as a professor at an international acedmic center her marriage was like a fairy tale and act the starting time passed her excitement vanished some – where . there are many reasons that her marriage did not succeed . such as they both were from different countries and from different cultures their friend circle was not same . they had nothing common to disscuss about . but the main reason was her husband's linguist had its own share of strain . nalini's husband nutured a selective society of fellow linguists who had this strange . habit of communicating in multiple languages. naturally , nalini found it difficult to keep pace with them. at times , she felt like an outsider and at other times .she was made to feel like one. she tried to disscuss the matter with her husband . however , he only had a quiet contempt for an answer. gradually diffidence set in . nalini felt as retreated into a shell , which made things worse .

Time flew by after few months they got dinorced . they dicided to get seprated but their were live separately but will keep in touch . she once sad to narrator of course , they could not save their maarriage decided to keep in touch . no it was not enough the loneliness, the pain , the yearing killed me. Thus her marriage with linguist did not succeed.



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## UNIT 2: A DREAM WITHIN A DREAM BY EDGAR ALLAN POE

Q1. Write in brief about the poet Edgar Allan Poe.

Ans Edgar allan poe was a brilliant American poet, journalist, short story writer and literary critic.in his life time he was the first American writer who was the more famous in Europe than America. the writing of poe has inspired various thinkers and writer including H.Plovercraft, jules veme and Charles Baudelaire. he has also played a big rote in the development of literary genres of mystery and science fiction. poe was born in boston, Massachusetts on 19 january 1809. his father and mother were prafassional actors and members of a repertory company in boston. poe's father left around the same time when he was born and after a few years, his life (unger 1079). poe was taken in by john and frances allan. the cauple gaue him a respectable upbringing brt never officially adopted him. this was why poe felt libe an outcast. due to all this , he suffered from depression, which made his writings very beautiful. he was good in academica but was mocked by was poers because of his actors parents. he was invowed in hambling and was in a huge dept. when the allans acquired some money, they sent poe to university of verginia at Charlottesville in 1825 but was compellecd to quit after less than a year due to bad depts and insufficunt financial backing from allan. his relationship urith allan began to break down after his return to Richmond in 1827. he was enlisted in the army in boston and fublished his first poetry collection.

"Tamerlane and other poems" but could not get success and his second collection "al. aaraaf, tamerlane and minor poems" came out in 1829 and received only slightly more attention. in the same year, poe was honourably released from the army . he then enrolted to the united states military academy at west point just to please john. when his fostes mothers died john did not give him sufficient founds to maintain himself as a cadet and as a hesult he was dismissed from the academy letter he went to Baltimore to live writh his aunt, Mrs maria clemm and her daughter Virginia clemm. poe's first short storiges published in the phil delphia Saturday courier and his Ms found in a bottle won a cash prize for the best story in the battimore Saturday visitor. poe worked in varions magazines, as an editor. poe was famous for both portry and fiction and as a literary critic. in 1836 poe married virgina clemm. 6 years letter Virginia became ill and after fighting it for 5 years the died in 1847. unable to cope up writh the loss . poe began drinking heavely and became involved in a number of romantic affairs.

Poe's writings gained attention in the last 1830s and early 1840s, however, the profits from his work were ensufficient. he sustain himsiff by editing some of the famous magazines of new York and philadephia.

While preparing for his second marriage poe came back to Baltimore in late 1849 he was found in a state of sems-consciousness on October 3, and he died four days later.

Q2. What are the various themes explored by the Poe?

Ans Poe explored various themes in his writings such as death, love, impermanca and uncertainty, the subconscious self, nature, hope and despair, and human imagination 1

1. **Death:** A large portion of poe's fietion contains musings on the nature of death and on querica about the after life in some of his works like "the city in the sea"the bells, Eldorado and the conqueror worm, death is describe as the end of a decaying process that started long before poe does not essentially come to the some conclusion about death in every pome especially in the case of the raven and Lenore white guy de vere of Lenore belives that he will again see raven begins to believes that he will again see Lenore in heaven the narrator of the raven begins to believe that he will nevermore see Lenore.



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2. **Love:** A Common Theme Wethin poe's work is that of a woman who has died at the height of aher youth and beauty.leaving a bereaved lover behind to grieve.in most of the cases, similarities can be drawn between the female in question and poe's unweel and deceased wife, Virginia clemm. poe portrays the female as naïve or child like, which remember Virginia,s yrung age at the time of marriage. poe describes love through the young and innocent protagonists of "tamerlane" and "Annabel lee" the narrator of ulalume roams through the woods but is irresistibly drown to her tomb, and the narrator of Annabel lee sleeps every night next to her grave by the sea.
3. **Impermanence And Uncertainty:** A within a dream deals most precisely with the disturbing idea that reality is temporary and nothing more than a dream. as the marrator first parts from his lover and then struggles with his inability to clasp the nature of a short lived truth. however various other poems touch upon the certainty of the end as in "the conqueror worm" one of poe's least optimistic poems that proclaim that all men are affected by unseen forces until their inevitable and unfortunately gruesome deaths.
4. **The Subconscious Self:** In his short compositions, poe frequently uses the idea of a double that stand for his primal in instinctive or subconscious. in some cases, for enample in "ulalume" the double acts as the expression of instinctive wisdom and here the narrator's psyche attempts to guide him awayfrom the path to ulalume's tomb. in other situations as in "the raven" the narrator encounters a double that symbolizes his deepest fears, which in turn finally subjugate his conscious rational self. the narrator of "the raven" at first ingnores messages of the bird he finished the pome by understanding its word "nevermore" as the refusal of all is hopes he has propelled his soul into the body of the bird.
5. **Nature:** Poe often linked writh good like in "tamerlane" where tamerlane and his childhood friend discover love and happiness in nature until he leaver to enjoy the companionship of other men and falls victim to ambition and pride many of poe's central character wander in nature and learn something about their deepset thoughts for example, just like the narration of "ulalume", who roams in wood and unintentionally reaches to his beloved tomb. poe also vieuls cities in negative manner, "the city in the sea". finally sinks into hell after wasting away under the impact of personified death.
6. **The Human Imagination:** Poe focus on the competences of the human mind most openly in sonnet "to science" ehere the narrator poet griever that the dedening effect of modem science has constrained the power of imagination other poems deal with the imagination in the rather dissimilar manner presenting the risks of the imagination when not strengthened by a sense of reality. the narrator of "the raven" reprents this behavior., though the initially attempts to describe the possibly unearthly phenomenon of the raven via rational measure. he finally ugnores his rational mind in his grief as an emotional being and supernatural messenger.
7. **Hope And Despair:** By inlisting his characters in situations of loss and regret, poe explores the varienty of human emotions such as hope and despair writh his writings. on the one hand, poems such as "the conqueror worm" and "the raven" mainly endorse derpair in "Eldorado" the "pilgrim shadow" tells his elderly knight that he needs to venture boldly into the valley of the shadow to accomplish his objective.

Q3. Write a brief note on Poe and his contemporaries.

Ans The 19 century was known for an amazing group of literary figures. many great poets were famous in this century among them some of the poets are discussed below on the first spot of my list was a famous American poet and writer edger allan poe who was more famous in Europe than in America. poe was born in boston, on 19 january 1809.

He was taken in by john and frances allan because his father left around the time he was born and few years latter his mother also passed away. poe has written so many classica such as



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"The narrative of Arthur Gordon pym of Nantucket", "The fall of the house of usher" and "The purloined letter to name a few" a dream wirthim a dream, tamerlane and other poems.

**Charles Dickness:** Charles dickness was the most popular Victorian novelist and is still considered a titan of literature. Charles (7 february 1812 9 june 1870) was an English writer and social critic. he created some of the world's best known fictional characters. despite his lack of formal education he edited a "Weekly journal" for 20 years, wrote 15 nivels, 100 of short stories and nonfictional articles. his famous woeks are "The pickwick papers", oliver twist, a Christmas carol, a tale of two cities, and great expectation.

**Waet Whitman:** He was born in 31 may 1819 and died in 26 march 1892. he was poet, essayist journalist and a humanist. he was often called the father of free verse .his poetry collection "leaves of grass" was very controversial in its time.

He worked as a lournalist, a teacher a government clerk and was a volunteer nurse during the American civil war.his famous works are "franklin evans (1842), "Leaves of grass", drum taps and democratic vistas.

Q4. What effect does the rhyme have on the poem's content? Does it make it seem more or less serious?

Ans This poem rhymes and in the first stanza, the rhyming scheme is AAABBCCDDBB whereas in the second stanza it is EEFFGGGHHIIBB. It has feet and is metered and the variations in feet and meter do not match the changes in the rhyming scheme. The couplets do not match in feet and meter, but do match in rhyme.

Q5. Does the speaker really believe all of life is a dream within a dream, or does he seem doubtful? How can you tell?

Ans "A dream within a dream" has a special implication to any understandings of the poem. Poe takes the idea of a daydream and twists it so that the narrator's opinion of reality happens at two degrees of detachment away from reality. Therefore, this reality contemplates upon itself through the medium of dreams, and the narrator can no longer distinguish causality in his perception. By showing the narrator's suffering at his observations, Poe increases the risks of uncertainty and of the potential changes to his identity. Time is a powerful but mysterious force that endorses cognitive discord between the protagonist's self and his abilities of understanding, and the daydream proves to have ensnared him. Otherwise, the poem itself may be viewed as the outermost dream, where the inner dream is just a function of the narrator's mind.

Q6. Write about Poe and his personal life. Do you think that his personal life served as a source of inspiration for him?

Ans His personal life served as a source of inspiration for him because Edgar Allan Poe was a brilliant American poet, journalist, short story writer and literary critic. The poem *A Dream within a Dream* is one of the many masterpieces written by the acclaimed writer. Poe's theory of literary creation is well known for two vital ideas (1) a work should create a unity of effect on the reader to be considered successful and (2) the production of this particular effect should not be left to the threats of accident or inspiration. There is a psychological intensity, which is characteristic of Poe's writings, particularly the tales of horror that contains his well-known works. These stories include *The Black Cat*, *The Cask of Amontillado* and *The Tell-Tale Heart*. Poe influenced many following authors and is considered a precursor of key literary movements such as symbolism and surrealism.

Q7. What is the theme of the poem 'A Dream within a Dream'?



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Ans A common theme within Poe's work is that of a woman who has died at the height of her youth and beauty, leaving a bereaved lover behind to grieve. In most of the cases, similarities can be drawn between the female in question and Poe's unwell and prematurely deceased wife, Virginia Clemm. Poe frequently portrays the female as naive or child-like, which remember Virginia's young age at the time of marriage. For Poe, the deepest and most lasting love commonly belonged to the young and innocent protagonists of *Tamerlane* and *Annabel Lee*. An approach in line with other contemporary writers of the Romantic era who deemed that childhood is the purest state of man. *To Helen* also highlights the nurturing role of a caring woman. After the death of the women in his works, the reaction of many of Poe's male protagonists is to continue to be emotionally dependent upon the deceased women to the point of obsession.

Q8. Give a detailed analyses of the lines, "Is all that we see or seem/But a dream within a dream?"

Ans There are several of Poe's poems. Especially, the refrain lines "All that we see or seem/Is but a dream within a dream" unite the passages in the poem's conclusion of ineffectiveness and remorse at the movement of time. Poe attracts attention to "all that we see or seem" with alliteration, and we can view this phrase as the combination of two aspects of reality, where "all that we see" is the external and "all that we seem" is the internal element. By asserting that both sides are the also alliterative phrase "a dream within a dream," Poe suggests that neither is more real than a dream.

Q9. Critically analyse the poem *A Dream within a Dream.*

Ans The structure of a dream withim a dream contains of two stanzas having two enrafated but eventually connected scenes. the first stanza shows the first person's opinion of the narrator separating from a lover, while at the second places of the narrator on a beach while uselessly trying to clasp a handful of band itn his hand . The juntaposed scenes contrast in a number of ways 'as the pome moves from a tranquil , though sincere, farewell to a more passionate second half.

In spite of the apparent dissimilarities beturen two stanzees,they are connected through the ironic resemblance of their evanescent natures. in the first inage, the narrator is separating from his lover, representing a sense of definiteness to their love. consequently the falling grcuns of sand in the second stanza recollect the images of an hourglass the that. as the passed , the loves time also vanishes, and the romanca and the sand each turn into effects from a dream.

Like several of poe's pomes, a dream urithim a dream uses the sea as a setting for a discussion of death and decay this city in the sea illustrates the imagery of a pitiless sea most clearly, writh the gothic allusions. to the end of time and im a dream within a dream, the "suff-tormented shore becomes a second metaphor for time. the narrator regards the weave as "pitiless", although the two stanzas are not alike in length but theor similar use of stressed rhyme and of couplets and triplets in their end rhyme scheme make a patterm that matches the parallel of their 2deas.

The poet uses six variations the feet vary between there and four variations the meter variation include- iambic, trochaic and spondees. for the reader, the iambic meter communicates a passive, a more natural gait tham the trachaic. the trochaic meter tends to be more urgent and insistent.

Q10. Why do you think the woman is in this poem? What effect does she have on its themes and message? Is she just a metaphor, or is she a real figure?

Ans Poe's work is that of a woman who has died at the height of her youth and beauty, leaving a bereaved lover behind to grieve. In most of the cases, similarities can be



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drawn between the female in question and Poe's unwell and prematurely deceased wife, Virginia Clemm. Poe frequently portrays the female as naive or child-like, which remember Virginia's young age at the time of marriage. For Poe, the deepest and most lasting love commonly belonged to the young and innocent protagonists of *Tamerlane* and *Annabel Lee*. An approach in line with other contemporary writers of the Romantic era who deemed that childhood is the purest state of man. *To Helen* also highlights the nurturing role of a caring woman. After the death of the women in his works, the reaction of many of Poe's male protagonists is to continue to be emotionally dependent upon the deceased women to the point of obsession.

Q11. Give a short note on the literary devices used in *A Dream within a Dream*.
Ans There is a variety of literary devices used in this poem to promote the message of the poem to the readers effectively. Like all of Poe's poems, the impact of the poetry on the reader is more clear and distinct. Assonance has been used in places like, in line 10 (see, seem), line 14 (hold, hand). Personification has also been used in line 6 "hope has flown away". Repetition is there in line 18 "while I weep" whereas onomatopoeia has been used in line 3 "avow". The poem also uses metaphor is in line 24 "pitiless wave".

Q12. Is the poem *A Dream within a Dream* about the nature of reality or the nature of loss? Can it be about both?
Ans Poe often linked nature with good, like in *Tamerlane*, where Tamerlane and his childhood friend discover love and happiness in nature until he leaves to enjoy the companionship of other men and falls victim to ambition and pride. Poe was part of the American Romantic movement of the early 19th century, when authors redirected their thoughts to nature so as to attain a purer and less evil state, away from the negative impacts of the society.

## UNIT 3: CHITRA BY RABINDRANATH TAGORE

Q1. How is love depicted as in the play *Chitra*? Support your answer.
Ans The play is the story of Chitrângadâ and Arjuna from the *Mahabharata* and begins with Chitra initiating a conversation with Madana, the god of love, and Vasanta, the god of eternal youth and springtime. They ask Chitra who she is and what is worrying her, to which she replies that she is the daughter of the king of Maripur and has been brought up like a boy as her father had no male heir. She is a great warrior and a hero in spite of being born as a woman, but has never had any chance to truly live like a woman or learn how to use "feminine wiles". Chitra explains that she had met the warrior hero Arjuna after seeing him in the forest while she was hunting for game. Despite knowing that he had pledged several vows including one for twelve years of celibacy, Chitra fell instantly in love with him. The following day she tried to speak to him and plead her case, but Arjuna turned her away due to his vows. Chitra begs with the two gods to give her a day of perfect beauty so she can win over Arjuna and have just one night of love with him. Moved by her pleas, the two gods give her not just one day but an entire year to spend with Arjuna. The next scene opens with Arjuna admiring over the perfect beauty he has seen. The play ends with Chitra finally admitting to Arjuna that she is the princess of which he spoke
of and that she pleaded for beauty in order to win him over. She confesses that she is not a perfect beauty, but that if he would accept her then she would stay with him forever. Chitra also discloses that she is pregnant with his son. Arjuna meets this news with joy and states that his life is truly full.

Q2. Critically analyse the play *Chitra*.
Ans Chitra is the princess of Manipur. She is brought up as a warrior. When she glances at Arjuna in his ascetic robes for the first time, she becomes conscious of the fact or reality of her being a woman. She considers that she is beautiful enough to win his heart. She woos Arjuna but in vain,



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for he rejects her on the ground of his vow of celibacy. She does not abandon her love for she is not the kind of woman who nourishes her despair in lonely silence feeding it with nightly tears and covering it with the daily patient smile. In fact, Tagore has pointed out that the flower of her desire refuses to droop before it has been ripened into a fruit. She consequently chooses the easy path of illusion, i.e., the acquired dazzle of beauty bestowed on her by the gods, Madana (god of Love) and Vasanta (god of Spring). In this role she fascinates and wins the heart of Arjuna who kneels down at Chitra's feet and begs for her love. Chitra is fully conscious that her procured beauty would shortly vanish, as the petals fall from an overblown flower, the only moment of her sweet union would slip from her, leaving her ashamed of her exposed poverty, which she will spend weeping day and night. It is impossible for her to keep her disguise and she prefers to accept the hard truth sooner than the false happiness. There is another aspect of Chitra's personality as a terror of evil doers and as father and mother to her people. It lies in the fact of her being a brave girl. She is a man in valour, but all woman in tenderness. Arjuna thinks of her as the goddess of Victory.

Like a watchful lioness she protects the litter at her dugs with a fierce love. Thus before parting from Chitra, Arjuna accepts her in bliss when she casts on him a tranquilizing spell. Chitra becomes all the more beautiful because she has known love, and because she is now a prospective mother.

Q3. Discuss feminism in Tagore's writings taking into account *Chitra*.

Ans Modern age is considered the age of feminism. The women in the modern period have crossed the barriers of society. They have proved their equality to their male counterparts. The modern women are not Feminism is a kind of revolt of women against social conventions. Feminine consciousness is, of course, consciousness of females for equality with males.

An attempt has been made to focus on the feminism reflected in Tagore's 'Chitra', 'NatirPuja' and 'Chandalika' in this paper. In good olden days, a woman was considered as sub ordinate and parasite. She was not independent to lead her life. The rights of woman were completely neglected. Rabindranath Tagore has brought out his women out of the kitchen and placed them in the active stream of life. Feminism in Rabindranath Tagore challenges the traditional view of woman as the weaker sex. Tagore's Chitra is as strong as man is. She is expert in riding, hunting, duel and war. She is a type of terror for the evildoers in the state. She had ambition to challenge Arjuna in single combat. When Arjuna in the forest rejects her, she does not go home weeping. She tries to show her strength and power by gaining perfect beauty from Madana. She seeks revenge against her insult of rejection by making him to surrender before her borrowed beauty. Chitra lived in a good olden days but she had a sense of feminism as a modern woman. She proved her equality. She equalled herself with her ancestors who made penance for child. Srimati in "NatirPuja" makes supreme sacrifice which is dazzling one. She has equalled herself with the males who sacrificed for the noble cause of religion.

Q4. Discuss early life and works of Tagore.

OR

Q5. Write a note on multitalented Rabindranath Tagore.

Ans Rabindranath Tagore. the youngest of thirteen surviving children was born in the Jorasanko mansion in Calcutta, India to Debendranath Tagore (1817–1905) and Sarada Devi (1830–1875). The Tagore family came into prominence during the Bengal Renaissance that began during the age of Hussein Shah (1493–1519). The original name of the Tagore family was Banerjee, however, being Brahmins, their ancestors were called 'Thakurmashai' or 'Holy Sir'. During the British rule, this name stuck and they began to be known as Thakur and in due course the family name got anglicised to Tagore. Poet, writer and humanitarian, Rabindranath Tagore was the first Indian to be awarded the Nobel Prize for Literature and played a key role in the renaissance of modern India.

Tagore's activism and literary work challenged the contradictions of an unequal and unfair world system and developed a new understanding of the society and the world in



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order to establish a concrete and universal humanism. The youngest of thirteen surviving children, Rabindranath Tagore was born in the Jorasanko mansion in Kolkata, India to parents Debendranath Tagore (1817–1905) and Sarada Devi (1830–1875).

After returning to Jorosanko and completed a set of major works by 1877, one of them a long poem in the Maithili style of Vidyapati; they were published pseudonymously. He introduced the short-story genre in Bengali with "Bhikharini" ("The Beggar Woman"), and his *Sandhya Sangit* (1882) includes the famous poem "Nirjharer Swapnabhanga" ("The Rousing of the Waterfall"). In 1883, he married Mrinalini Devi, born Bhabatarini, 1873–1902; they had five children, two of whom died in childhood. In 1901 Tagore moved to Santiniketan to found an ashram with a marble-floored prayer hall—*The Mandir*—an experimental school, groves of trees, gardens, a library. In 1921, Tagore and agricultural economist Leonard Elmhirst set up the "Institute for Rural Reconstruction", later renamed Shriniketan or "Abode of Welfare", in Surul, a village near the *ashram*. Known mostly for his poetry, Tagore wrote novels, essays, short stories, travelogues, dramas and thousands of songs.

Tagore's experiences with drama began when he was sixteen, with his brother Jyotirindranath Tagore Tagore wrote his first original dramatic piece when he was twenty—*Valmiki Pratibha*. In old age, Tagore still rose long before dawn to witness the birth of each new day, and he still wrote fluently in his own hand.

Q7. Tagore's dramas used more philosophical and allegorical themes. Explain.

Ans Tagore's dramas used more philosophical and allegorical themes. In it the pandit Valmiki overcomes his sins, is blessed by Saraswati, and compiles the *Râmâyana*. Through it Tagore explores a varied range of dramatic styles and emotions, including usage of refurbished *kirtans* and adaptation of traditional Irish and English folk melodies as drinking songs. Another play, *Dak Ghar* (*The Post Office*), depicts the child Amal challenging his stuffy and childish confines by ultimately "fall[ing] asleep", hinting his physical death. A story with borderless appeal—gleaning rave reviews in Europe—*Dak Ghar* dealt with death as, in Tagore's words, "spiritual freedom" from "the world of hoarded wealth and certified creeds".

Q8. Write a note on the characters in the play *Chitra*.

Ans Chitra is the princess of Manipur. She is brought up as a warrior. When she glances at Arjuna in his ascetic robes for the first time, she becomes conscious of the fact or reality of her being a woman. She considers that she is beautiful enough to win his heart. She woos Arjuna but in vain, for he rejects her on the ground of his vow of celibacy. She does not abandon her love for she is not the kind of woman who nourishes her despair in lonely silence feeding it with nightly tears and covering it with the daily patient smile. In fact, Tagore has pointed out that the flower of her desire refuses to droop before it has been ripened into a fruit. She consequently chooses the easy path of illusion, i.e., the acquired dazzle of beauty bestowed on her by the gods, Madana (god of Love) and Vasanta (god of Spring). In this role she fascinates and wins the heart of Arjuna who kneels down at Chitra's feet and begs for her love. Chitra is fully conscious that her procured beauty would shortly vanish, as the petals fall from an overblown flower, the only moment of her sweet union would slip from her, leaving her ashamed of her exposed poverty, which she will spend weeping day and night. It is impossible for her to keep her disguise and she prefers to accept the hard truth sooner than the false happiness. There is another aspect of Chitra's personality as a terror of evil doers and as father and mother to her people. It lies in the fact of her being a brave girl. She is a man in valour, but all woman in tenderness. Arjuna thinks of her as the goddess of Victory:

Like a watchful lioness she protects the litter at her dugs with a fierce love. Thus before parting from Chitra, Arjuna accepts her in bliss when she casts on him a tranquilizing spell. Chitra



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becomes all the more beautiful because she has known love, and because she is now a prospective mother.

## UNIT 4: ODE TO THE WEST WIND BY P B SHELLEY

Q1. Give a detailed analysis of Shelley's themes and motifs.
Ans analysis of Shelley's themes and motifs- The central thematic concerns of Shelley's poetry are largely the same themes that definedRomanticism, especially among the younger English poets of Shelley's era: the sanctity of the imagination, passions, political liberty, nature, creativity, and beauty. Shelley's philosophical relationship to his subject matter makes his treatment of these themes unique. These themes were better developed and expressed than any other Romantic poet with the exception of Wordsworth. Wordsworth's temperament was extremely sensitive and receptive even for a Romantic poet, and possessed an extraordinary capacity for hope, love and joy. Shelley ardently believed in the possibility of realising an ideal of human gladness as based on beauty. Also, his moments of despair and gloominess (specifically in book-length poems, for example, *Queen Mab*) usually originate from his discontent at seeing that ideal sacrificed to human weakness.
Shelley's strong feelings about beauty and expression are depicted in poems like *Ode to the West Wind* and *Ode to a Skylark*. In the poems, he cites metaphors from nature to characterise his relationship to his art. The centre of his artistic philosophy can be found in his significant essay, *A Defence of Poetry*, in which he argues that poetry brings about moral good. Shelley argues that poetry, expands and exercises the imagination, and imagination is the source of love, compassion and sympathy. It rests on the ability to project oneself into the position of another person.
**He writes, "A man, to be greatly good, must imagine intensely and comprehensively; he must** put himself in the place of another and of many others. The pains and pleasures of his species must become his own. The great instrument of moral good is the imagination; and poetry administers to the effect by acting upon the cause. Poetry enlarges the circumference of the imagination by replenishing it with thoughts of ever new delight, which have the power of attracting and assimilating to their own nature all other thoughts, and which form new intervals and interstices whose void forever craves fresh food. Poetry strengthens the faculty which is the organ of the moral nature of man, in the same manner as exercise strengthens a limb." No other English poet of the early 19th century emphasised the association between beauty and goodness, or believed so passionately in the power of art's sensual pleasures for the betterment of society. Keats believed in beauty and aesthetics for their sake, on the contrary, Byron's pose was one of immoral sensuousness, or of scandalous rebelliousness. However, Shelley was of the belief that poetry makes people and society better and his poetry is suffused with this type of motivated moral optimism, which he hoped would influence his readers spiritually, morally and sensuously all at the same time.

Q2. Write on symbolism in Shelley's poetry. Give an example.
Ans **Symbols-Mont Blanc-**
For Shelley, Mont Blanc, which is the highest mountain peak in the Alps, signifies the everlasting power of nature. Mont Blanc has been in existence forever, and will last eternally, an idea that the poet explores in *Mont Blanc*. The mountain fills the poet with motivation, but its coldness and unreachability are frightening. Eventually, Shelley ponders if the mountain's power might be futile, an invention of the more dominant human imagination.

**The West Wind**

Shelley uses the West Wind to represent the power of nature and of the source of imagination. Unlike Mont Blanc, the West Wind is depicted as dynamic and active in poems like *Ode to the*



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*West Wind*. While Mont Blanc is immovable, the West Wind is an agent for change. Even as it destroys, the wind supports new life on earth and social development among humanity.

**The Statue of Ozymandias**

In Shelley's work, the statue of the ancient Egyptian pharaoh Ramses II, or Ozymandias, represents political oppression. In *Ozymandias*, (1817) the statue is broken into pieces and abandoned in an empty desert, which suggests that tyranny is temporary and that no political leader, especially an unfair one, can expect to have lasting power. The broken monument also signifies the deterioration of civilization and culture. The statue is, after all, a piece of art made by a creator, which along with its creator have been destroyed, similar to all living things.

Q3. Is the speaker in *Ode to the West Wind* a representative of all mankind, or is he unique or special in some way?

Ans The speaker asks the wind to "make me thy lyre," to be his own Spirit, and to drive his thoughts across the universe, "like withered leaves, to quicken a new birth." He asks the wind, by the incantation of this verse, to scatter his words among mankind, to be the "trumpet of a prophecy." Speaking both about the season and about the effect upon mankind that he hopes his words to have, the speaker asks, "If winter comes, can spring be far behind?"

Q4. What will happen to the dormant seeds once the west wind's sister blows her clarion?

Ans In this first of the five sections of the poem, the speaker defines the areas and the powers of the West Wind. Stanza I describes the wind's effects on the land, stanza II discusses the wind's effect on the sky and stanza III addresses its impacts on the sea. The autumn breeze disperses dead leaves and seeds on the forest floor, where they finally sprout into new plants. The wind is called both "destroyer and preserver"

Q5. In poem *Ode to the West Wind*, throughout stanza II, the poet describes the approaching storm and the elements that the west wind will bring. Describe the storm in your own words.

Ans In poem *Ode to the West Wind*, throughout stanza II the poet describes the approaching storm and the elements that according to me the wail of the wind is compared to a song of grief, as if it were grieving the "dying" year. As the year ends, nature prepares for the funeral as the coming night is defined as
a "sepulcher," a burial tomb that will be marked by lightning and hail from a storm.

Q6. In lines 53-54, the poet has '(fallen) upon the thorns of life...' He wishes he could be free of life's burdens. Quote how he phrases his desire to escape the 'thorns of life' in these lines.

Ans Oh, lift me as a wave, a leaf, a cloud!
I fall upon the thorns of life! I bleed!

Shelley's critics have usually ridiculed these famous lines. Here, the patterns of earth, sea and sky are remembered as the speaker asks to be lifted from his sorrows by the inspiring West Wind. He appears almost Christ-like in his suffering, the "thorns of life" recollecting the crown of thorns worn by Christ during the crucifixion.

Q7. In line 55-56, the poet says he used to have strength like the west wind has, but now how does he describe himself?

Ans A heavy weight of hours has chained and bowed
One too like thee: tameless, and swift, and proud.



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The Christ-like image of the speaker continues in these lines. His life experiences have been like heavy crosses for him to bear and have weighed him down. Despite that, there is spark of life and hope inside him. He can still remember the time when he had several of the wind's qualities and powers.

Q8. The last line of the poem is often quoted. What do you understand the line to mean—other than that one season follows another?
Ans The last line of the poem Shelley initially framed the last two lines as a statement, expressed as a question and the poem ends on a note of suspense rather than affirmation. The speaker has made his case and plea to help the wind in the announcement of a new age. However, he has not received an answer yet. Together with his audience, the speaker eagerly awaits a "yes", delivered on the wings of the wind.

## UNIT 5: THE VENDOR OF SWEETS BY R K NARAYAN

Q1. Evaluate *The Vendor of Sweets* as a unique Indian English novel.
Ans In The Vendor of Sweets, Narayan adopts a Selective Omniscient point of view; it is the **Notes** father–son relationship or the conflict of two generations, which plays the dominant role in developing the action and shaping the narrative. The novel depicts the opposition between two value systems—spiritualistic and materialistic—operating in the post-colonial Indian society. In The Vendor of Sweets, once again the theme is man's quest for identity and self-renewal. The protagonist Jagan is a sweet-vendor by profession, follower of the Gita in thinking and talker of Gandian principles but he indulges in double-dealing in matters of money, and also cheats sales-tax authorities. He comes to realize that money is evil when his son, Mali, comes back to India with a Korean girl, Grace and asks for money for his business. Jagan finds new life or a new birth in his retirement, when he surrenders his business to his cousin. His fragile Gandhian self-regard collapses before his much-loved son's strange actions; and after Mali ends up disastrously in prison as a result of driving drunk around Malgudi, Jagan has no option but a Hindu-style renunciation of the world, bewilderment and retreat to a simpler life. Nevertheless,
even here his ideal of Sanyasa is spurious as he still holds the purse string.

Q2. Draw a character sketch of Mali.
Ans Mali is a son of Jagan.Jagan main interest and concern was his only son, Mali. Mali's mother died of brain tumour several years back. The barrier between the father and the son came into being the day the mother died. It might be that Mali, a little bewildered and dismayed, felt obscurely that in some way his father was responsible for his mother's death. Jagan was an advocate of nature cure. Jagan's love both for his wife and his son was deep and unwavering. The tragedy is that when he lost his wife, he lost also any affection that his son might have had for him. Jagan's love for the son was so much that he hastened home from his shop in the evenings thinking that the boy would be lonely. However, Mali did not rise to his expectations and he preferred to be alone and detached. It led to a total estrangement between the two. Even after having lived twenty years with his son, Jagan knew very little about him. Jagan was very proud of his son but he had no control over
him. Mali gave up his studies and went to America. Mali's letters from America only added Jagan's worries. Jagan could not think of his son eating beef. He was a true Gandhian and a vegetarian. During India's freedom struggle, he had been arrested for hoisting Indian flag. He lived a very simple life. He ate food cooked by his own hands. He never used sugar or salt since he believed that they were detrimental to health. When Mali announced to Jagan that the girl was his wife, Jagan was shocked. Still he loved them, gave due respect and allowed them to stay in his house. He accepted Grace as his daughter-in-law. She also behaved admirable towards him. Soon cracks developed not only between Jagan and Mali but also between Mali and Grace. Jagan was



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unwilling to finance a huge amount of money for Mali's establishment of story-writing machine. It was too much for Jagan when Grace announced to him that Mali and Grace had been living together without being married. Moreover, Mali was not even willing to marry her. The ever-growing tension in father-son relationship
reached its climax when Mali was caught red-handed for breaking the prohibition laws. Then there came in Jagan's life the moment of self-realisation and of decision. He managed to break away from Mali and his scheming and vicious world, which he could not approve. He escaped from the chains of paternal love. Jagan abandoned the world and retired into a life of spiritual devotion. He was altogether unaffected to hear that Mali was in jail as the police had caught him with liquor in his car. He thought that a period of jail might be good for the young man. Jagan then asks his cousin to make sure that Mali stays in prison for some time, so that he can learn his mistakes. Jagan also gives some amount of money to the cousin so that he can buy a plane ticket to Grace so she can go back to her hometown.

Q3. Write a detailed analysis on the character of Jagan.
Ans The character of Jagan, the 55-year-old vendor of sweets, is broad and firm in outline, convincing and natural in full personality and essentially true to nature. Jagan's character is a curious mixture of innocence and shrewdness, humble simplicity and delightful eccentricity and he has a heart full of tenderness for his late wife and his 'poor boy.' He is a strict follower of Gandhi in all matters, in Truth, Satyagraha, Charkha-spinning, in dress, not the least, in non-violent footwear. His never-to-be-published *magnum opus* is on Nature Cure and Natural Diet with his immense faith in the properties of margosa, for brushing the teeth or for relief from headache, incorporating his ideas on 'the whole secret or human energy' and dietetic prevention or cure for premature white hair. Jagan at a symbolic level suffers the gall and sorrow, confusion and bewilderment of the traditional, uncontaminated old Indian generation when sneered at and jettisoned by the artificial civilisation with its machine-produced literature and strange values. Jagan, a college-educated man in the late fifties has made a success of his sweet shop. However, he grew quite rich as a sweet-vendor, his main interest and concern was his only son, Mali. Mali's mother died of brain tumour several years back. The barrier between the father and the son came into being the day the mother died. It might be that Mali, a little bewildered and dismayed, felt obscurely that in some way his father was responsible for his mother's death. Jagan was an advocate of nature cure. Jagan's love both for his wife and his son was deep and unwavering. The tragedy is that when he lost his wife, he lost also any affection that his son might have had for him. Jagan's love for the son was so much that he hastened home from his shop in the evenings thinking that the boy would be lonely.

OR

Jagan is the most vibrant character of the novel from the first page to the last. Mali, his son who returned from America with a half-American half-Korean girl whom he reported as his wife and later said he never married, had been something of a sensation disturbing the placid waters of Malgudi. However, Mali is insignificant when compared to his father.
Twelve of the thirteen chapters of the book deal with Jagan, a widower nearing sixty. He is not likely to celebrate his *shashtabyapurti,* as no one seems to care. The last but one of the thirteen chapters deals with flashbacks of Jagan's boyhood, youth, marriage, his begetting Mali after years of waiting and prayer. This with other references in the course of the book to Jagan's relationship with his elder brother and the tragic way he lost his wife completes the picture telling us all we need to know of him.

Q4. Analyse the themes in *The Vendor of Sweets.*



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Ans It is possible to read The Vendor of Sweets as a merely amusing story, which depends for its comedy on the improbable and fantastic. However, there is much more in it than is apparent on the surface. While it seems to tell the amusing story of an eccentric and obscurantist father and his upstart son, and the game of hide and seek they play with each other, in fact it is built on a few inter-related themes of which the most readily obvious is the father-son motif. The others are youth versus age, the generation gap, tradition versus modernity, East versus West, and search or quest. The quest motif is the most meaningful in the novel and encompasses all the others. Jagan the protagonist of the novel, by virtue of the circumstances of his life, engaged himself in different kinds of search. However, he is not a deliberate and self-conscious quester, nor is he capable of sophisticated intellectual inquiry. What is more, he is hardly aware of some of the searches he is involved in.

Q5. How is Gandhian philosophy an integral part of the story? What does it signify?

Ans In Jagan's quest his profession of faith in Gandhian ideals and the teachings of the Bhagavadgita, and his interest in the sculpting of the idol of Gayatri the Goddess of radiance and enlightenment, all play a part in varying degrees. It is better stated at the outset that *The Vendor of Sweets* is not a "Gandhi Novel" and that Narayan has not written one such. Nor does it aim at expressing any particular attitude towards Gandhi and his way of life. However, the novelist uses the Gandhian motif, to study a certain kind of man who claims to be a follower of Gandhi (P. 15). He gives us a meticulously detailed account of Jagan's apparently Gandhian habits. He wears only simple and plain Khaddar clothes made of yarn he himself has spun on the *Charkha*. He has been spinning on it since Gandhi visited Malgudi "over twenty years ago" (P. 15). He produces enough yarn to meet his sartorial requirements, which consist of just two sets of clothes. He has made it a point to wear only "nonviolent footwear," "sandals made of the leather of an animal which had died of old age." Jagan's experiments in dietetics, his quackish enthusiasm for nature cure, his austerity and determination to be self-reliant regarding his personal needs, his needless conquest of taste, and his proud claim regarding his "simple living and high thinking, as Gandhi taught us" (P. 45), all these make him an eccentric and rather comic Gandhi man. However, he also accumulates wealth, largely by evading tax, even though he claims that one who "came under the spell of Gandhi" "could do no wrong" (P. 45). With his tongue in the cheek, the author says that if Gandhi had said anywhere that one should pay his sales tax uncomplainingly, Jagan would have certainly done so.

Q6. Describe the conflict between spirituality and materialism in all the novels of R K Narayan, especially *The Vendor of Sweets*.

Ans As part of East-West conflict, one can notice the conflict between spirituality and materialism in all the novels of R K Narayan. Due to the colonial rule and western education, modern materialism got into Indian minds. Spirituality, the hallmark of the Indians started to ebb from people's way of life. Thus, there appeared open conflict between the elder, uneducated Indians and the younger, educated ones. Conflict is also visible within the minds of the younger generations—between their inherited spiritual self and the acquired material self. The characters of Narayan's novels can be divided into two categories: spiritualists and materialists. The novel depicts the opposition between two value systems—spiritualistic and materialistic— operating in the post-Indian society. However, the conflict is of a knotty and intricate character. "Both Jagan and Mali experience the opposition between traditional Indian values and the modern Western values. Mali, with all his national, progressive modern attitudes ends up in prison and Jagan for all his faith in the traditional Indian culture becomes a modern sanyasi"

Q7. Explain the theme of order and disorder in the story.

Ans **The theme**- It is possible to read The Vendor of Sweets as a merely amusing story, which depends for its comedy on the improbable and fantastic. However, there is much more in it than is



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apparent on the surface. While it seems to tell the amusing story of an eccentric and obscurantist father and his upstart son, and the game of hide and seek they play with each other, in fact it is built on a few inter-related themes of which the most readily obvious is the father-son motif. The others are youth versus age, the generation gap, tradition versus modernity, East versus West, and search or quest. The quest motif is the most meaningful in the novel and encompasses all the others. Jagan the protagonist of the novel, by virtue of the circumstances of his life, engaged himself in different kinds of search. However, he is not a deliberate and self-conscious quester, nor is he capable of sophisticated intellectual inquiry. What is more, he is hardly aware of some of the searches he is involved in.

Q8. Discuss the title of *The Vendor of Sweets.*

Ans Mali and Grace were the vendors of sweets in the story *The Vendor of Sweets. The Vendor of Sweets* was first published in London in 1967 by The Bodley Head Ltd. In The Vendor of Sweets, Narayan adopts a Selective Omniscient point of view; it is the In The Vendor of Sweets, Narayan adopts a Selective Omniscient point of view; it is the **Notes**

father–son relationship or the conflict of two generations, which plays the dominant role in developing the action and shaping the narrative. father–son relationship or the conflict of two generations, which plays the dominant role in developing the action and shaping the narrative.

Q9. Critically analyse the character of Mali.

Ans Mali: Jagan's son. Blames his father for his mother's death. After living in America, he dislikes his hometown and wants to "modernize" it. Mali's mother died of brain tumour several years back. The barrier between the father and the son came into being the day the mother died. It might be that Mali, a little bewildered and dismayed, felt obscurely that in some way his father was responsible for his mother's death. Jagan was an advocate of nature cure. Jagan's love both for his wife and his son was deep and unwavering. The tragedy is that when he lost his wife, he lost also any affection that his son might have had for him. Jagan's love for the son was so much that he hastened home from his shop in the evenings thinking that the boy would be lonely. However, Mali did not rise to his expectations and he preferred to be alone and detached. It led to a total estrangement between the two. Even after having lived twenty years with his son, Jagan knew very little about him. Jagan was very proud of his son but he had no control over him. Mali gave up his studies and went to America. Mali's letters from America only added Jagan's worries. Jagan could not think of his son eating beef. He was a true Gandhian and a vegetarian. During India's freedom struggle, he had been arrested for hoisting Indian flag. He lived a very simple life. He ate food cooked by his own hands. He never used sugar or salt since he believed that they were detrimental to health. When Mali announced to Jagan that the girl was his wife, Jagan was shocked. Still he loved them, gave due respect and allowed them to stay in his house. He accepted Grace as his daughter-in-law. She also behaved admirable towards him. Soon cracks developed not only between Jagan and Mali but also between Mali and Grace. Jagan was unwilling to finance a huge amount of money for Mali's establishment of story-writing machine. It was too much for Jagan when Grace announced to him that Mali and Grace had been living together without being married. Moreover, Mali was not even willing to marry her. The ever-growing tension in father-son relationship

reached its climax when Mali was caught red-handed for breaking the prohibition laws. Then there came in Jagan's life the moment of self-realisation and of decision. He managed to break away from Mali and his scheming and vicious world, which he could not approve. He escaped from the chains of paternal love. Jagan abandoned the world and retired into a life of spiritual devotion. He was altogether unaffected to hear that Mali was in jail as the police had caught him with liquor in his car. He thought that a period of jail might be good for the young man. Jagan then asks his cousin to make sure that Mali stays in prison for some time, so that he can learn his mistakes.



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Jagan also gives some amount of money to the cousin so that he can buy a plane ticket to Grace so she can go back to her hometown.

Q10. Tradition and modernity is finely blended in *The Vendor of Sweets*. Elaborate.
Ans *The Vendor of Sweets* is not merely a Hindu fable intended to illustrate man's passage from one *ashrama* to another but a novel set in modern India where individuals strive to make sense of a complex and fast changing life and how they are caught in clash of ideas and values. "Narayan's main discovery is the fact that traditional concepts like the *ashramas* and *purusharthas* in various disguises, distortions and subterfuges survive and continue to influence the lives of the people". The novel depicts the opposition between two value systems—spiritualistic and materialistic—operating in the post-Indian society. However, the conflict is of a knotty and intricate character. "Both Jagan and Mali experience the opposition between traditional Indian values and the modern Western values. Mali, with all his national, progressive modern attitudes ends up in prison and Jagan for all his faith in the traditional Indian culture becomes a modern sanyasi"

Q Draw a character sketch of Grace.
Ans Grace a half American and half korian girl mali brings home ,claiming she is his wife. she works like a catalyst between the two cultures ,and try to integrate into the Indian culture she has entered .when Grace tries to take up the household duties typical Indian daughters-in-law excel in then jagan is just as much at a loss . The image of Grace in her tucked-up sari, 'exposing her ivory-hued kneecap,' and engaging in humble housekeeping tasks is an incongruent one for Jagan. He begs her not to trouble herself and tries to argue that the neighbors will talk if they see a modern girl 'brought up in New York' engaging in such drudgery.Grace is not to be deterred; she insists that she is quite capable of rising to the occasion when the situation demands it. It is also Grace who cleans, transforms, and decorates Jagan's home (with a freshly artistic feminine touch) into a bewildering place of wonder for the old man. Her sense of curiosity and adventure initially strikes an answering chord in the lonely father's heart. Grace is just as comfortable navigating the transformation of her father-in-law's home as she is reveling in the exotic smell of the margosa leaf, considered an ambrosia in the Vedas. However, Jagan soon comes to resent the westernization of his home, both in moral as well as in aesthetic terms.

As time continues, Grace is able to carve out a friendly relationship with her father-in-law. Unlike her husband, Mali, Grace never belittles or patronizes Jagan. When Jagan objects to her cooking for him due to his dietary restrictions, she praises his foray into salt-free and sugar-free cooking. In relation to Mali, Grace sympathizes with Jagan's need to hear more about his son's plans for the future and to inquire as to Mali's educational status.When Grace reveals that she was actually the one who wrote to Jagan, the poor old man is flabbergasted. He had always thought the letters had come from Mali himself. Jagan eventually learns that his courteous and solicitous daughter-in-law is very much her own woman. As time continues, Jagan comes to despise Grace's part in encouraging him to financially support Mali's business schemes. He resolves to engage in the Gandhian non-violent, non-cooperative method to fend off what he thinks are the couple's designs on his money. Grace, for her part, is the one who finally reveals to Jagan that she and Mali are not married at all; the couple's relationship status is too modern for Jagan's liking, and he decides to wash his hands of the matter. In the story, Grace represents a character who is a sort of bridge between two world-views, one who respects the beauty of traditional customs but is not shackled by nationalistic loyalties to any one culture.

## UNIT 6: HOW MUCH LAND DOES A MAN NEED :BY LEO TOLSTOY



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Q1. What did Pahóm's avarice (greed) earn him in the end? Why does Pahóm die in his pursuit of the land?
Ans Tolstoy tells that greed starts from coveting of other's possessions. He starts his story with two women, arguing about whose life was better; a life with or without possessions. As the two continued, the master of the house, Pahom, thought to himself, "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself!" Pahom's thought that he would not do any sin if he had land started the whole process of greed and triggered the Devil to grant him his wishes for land. Therefore, Pahom ended up with lands to himself by the power of the Devil. When we covet other's possessions and let greed take over our mind, we often give in to the works of Devil over our lives. This showed how greed could make us fall into Devil's work. As the story progresses, Tolstoy conveys his message that greed has no boundaries. When Pahom gained land, he became possessive of the land and caused disputes with his neighbours. Due to threats by the neighbours, Pahom moved to a larger land where he could possess and grow more crops for himself. Whenever there was an opportunity to gain more land, Pahom, full of greed, moved to the other land to satisfy him. However, everywhere he moved, he was not satisfied with what he had. He looked for more and better land even though what he had was enough for him. Pahom's actions reflect the characteristics of greed again. As what Tolstoy tried to tell, greed has no boundaries. What we have with us does not seem satisfactory, and it keeps us to look for more.

Q2. What is the Bashkírs' "one thousand rubles a day" policy? What is the real test of the policy?
Ans Pahóm hears (from a tradesman) about the Bashkirs, a simple people who own a huge amount of land deep in Central Asia. After a long trek, Pahóm meets the Bashkirs on the vast steppe. He is prepared to negotiate a price for as much land as possible, but before he can do so, the Bashkirs make him a very unusual offer, the same one that they make to anyone who wishes to buy land from them. For one thousand rubles (a large sum in those days), Pahóm can buy as much land as he can walk around in one day. He has to start at daybreak and mark his route with a shovel at key points along the way. As long as he returns to the starting point before sunset, the land that he has marked off will be his. If he fails to return on time, he will lose his money and receive no land. He is delighted, as he believes that he can cover a great distance and has chanced upon the bargain of a lifetime.

Q3 Why does Pahóm die in his pursuit of the land? How much land does it take to bury him?
Ans Pahóm is certain that he can cover a great distance and that he will have more land than he could have ever imagined. That night, Pahóm has a surreal foreboding dream in which he sees himself lying dead at the feet of the Devil (who changes appearances – peasant, tradesman, chief of the Baskirs), who is laughing. The next day, with the Bashkirs watching from the starting point, Pahóm sets off at a good pace as soon as the sun crests the horizon. He covers a lot of ground, marking his way as he goes. At various points, he begins to think that he should change direction and work his way back, but he is constantly tempted by the thought of adding just a bit more land. The day wears on and, as the sun begins to set, Pahóm discovers that he is still far from the starting point. Realizing that he has been too greedy and taken too much land, he runs back as fast as he can to where the Bashkirs are waiting. He arrives at the starting point just in time just before the sun sets. However, as the Bashkirs cheer his good fortune, Pahóm drops dead from exhaustion. His servant buries him in an ordinary grave only six feet long, thus ironically answering the question posed in the title of the story.

Q4. Based on the title 'How Much Land Does a Man Need', what do you predict the moral of
Ans Tolstoy's short story – "How much land does a man need?"–is a religious-morality tale which can be interpreted in a variety of ways, but which seems primarily concerned with the destructive consequences of human ambition. The story is about a man named Pahom – a peasant farmer– who



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desires to acquire more land, acquires some land, but is not satisfied and needs to acquire more. Eventually he over-reaches, forfeits all his accumulated wealth and causes his own death. The message to take from the story may be as simple as a warning against biting off more than you can chew, or we could say simply that the story shows how human nature pushes us to want more and more. We are never content with our lives, no matter how well off we may be; and, while trying to improve our standard of living, we put ourselves in danger of ending up with nothing. However, the story can be understood as presenting a message of greater complexity. this story might be?

SUMMARY OF THE POEM

The protagonist of the story is a peasant named Pakhom, whose wife at the beginning can be heard complaining that they do not own enough land to satisfy them. He is a man of humble means who lives a decent life. However, after his sister-in-law has bragged that city folk have a much better life than country peasants do, Pahom bemoans the fact that he does not own land. He states, "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself!" Little does he know that the Devil is sitting close by and listening? The Devil says, "All right! We shall see about that. I'll give you land enough; and by means of that land I will get you into my power." Shortly thereafter, Pahóm manages to buy some land from a woman in his village. He works hard, makes a profit and is able to pay off his debts and live a more comfortable life. However, he is not satisfied and, after a **peasant** told him about the opportunity to own more land, he moves to a larger area of land... Pahóm grows more crops and amasses a small fortune, but it is still not content. Now another character tells him of another opportunity to own more land. Pahóm hears (from a tradesman) about the Bashkirs, a simple people who own a huge amount of land deep in Central Asia. After a long trek, Pahóm meets the Bashkirs on the vast steppe. He is prepared to negotiate a price for as much land as possible, but before he can do so, the Bashkirs make him a very unusual offer, the same one that they make to anyone who wishes to buy land from them. For one thousand rubles (a large sum in those days), Pahóm can buy as much land as he can walk around in one day. He has to start at daybreak and mark his route with a shovel at key points along the way. As long as he returns to the starting point before sunset, the land that he has marked off will be his. If he fails to return on time, he will lose his money and receive no land. He is delighted, as he believes that he can cover a great distance and has chanced upon the bargain of a lifetime. Pahóm is certain that he can cover a great distance and that he will have more land than he couldhave ever imagined. That night, Pahóm has a surreal foreboding dream in which he sees himself lying dead at the feet of the Devil (who changes appearances – peasant, tradesman, chief of the Baskirs), who is laughing. The next day, with the Bashkirs watching from the starting point, Pahóm sets off at a good pace as soon as the sun crests the horizon. He covers a lot of ground, marking his way as he goes. At various points, he begins to think that he should change direction and work his way back, but he is constantly tempted by the thought of adding just a bit more land. The day wears on and, as the sun begins to set, Pahóm discovers that he is still far from the starting point. Realizing that he has been too greedy and taken too much land, he runs back as fast as he can to where the Bashkirs are waiting. He arrives at the starting point just in time just before the sun sets. However, as the Bashkirs cheer his good fortune, Pahóm drops dead from exhaustion. His servant buries him in an ordinary grave only six feet long, thus ironically answering the question posed in the
title of the story.

**ANALYSIS** OF THE POEM

"How Much Land Does a Man Need?" is an 1886 short story by Leo Tolstoy about a man who, in his lust for land, forfeits everything. Since Adam and Eve ate the fruits from the Tree of the knowledge of Good and evil, humans desired to take possession of more than they need in benefit of themselves. Human desires have brought many of us away from our original natures that God



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gave in the beginning. We often waste our time that has been given pursuing materialistic things. The theme of the story "How much land does a man need?" by Leo Tolstoy clearly delivers its message that greed as no boundaries and will bring you to death. Tolstoy tells that greed starts from coveting of other's possessions. He starts his story with two women, arguing about whose life was better; a life with or without possessions. As the two continued, the master of the house, Pahom, thought to himself, "If I had plenty of land, I shouldn't fear the Devil himself!" Pahom's thought that he would not do any sin if he had land started the whole process of greed and triggered the Devil to grant him his wishes for land. Therefore, Pahom ended up with lands to himself by the power of the Devil. When we covet other's possessions and let greed take over our mind, we often give in to the works of Devil over our lives. This showed how greed could make us fall into Devil's work. As the story progresses, Tolstoy conveys his message that greed has no boundaries. When Pahom gained land, he became possessive of the land and caused disputes with his neighbours.

Due to threats by the neighbours, Pahom moved to a larger land where he could possess and grow more crops for himself. Whenever there was an opportunity to gain more land, Pahom, full of greed, moved to the other land to satisfy him. However, everywhere he moved, he was not satisfied with what he had. He looked for more and better land even though what he had was enough for him. Pahom's actions reflect the characteristics of greed again. As what Tolstoy tried to tell, greed has no boundaries. What we have with us does not seem satisfactory, and it keeps us to look for more. Tolstoy ends his story with an excellent example. On Pahom's last trip to find land, he gained an opportunity to gain land as much as he wanted. Pahom made a deal that he would gain the land.

## UNIT 7: THE AGONY OF WIN BY MALAVIKA ROY SINGH

Q1. Write a note on Malavika Roy Singh.

Ans Malavika Roy Singh was a financial analyst before taking up writing full time. She left her corporate job to fulfil her great desire for writing. An avid reader, Singh is fond of reading science fiction, thrillers, fantasy and fiction. Her passionate desire to read fuelled the longing for writing in her. Singh lives in Noida, India and spend most of her time in reading, writing and cooking. She is a great short story writer and indulges in writing for blogs and magazines.

Q2. What is the theme of the story 'The Agony of Win'? Elaborate.

Ans *The Agony of Win* is a simple short story about a woman who falls for her sister's husband, Sunil. She goes on to have an alleged affair with Sunil, which both of them tries to keep under wraps. However, Amrita is aware that she is not doing the right thing but is completely smitten by the charms of her brother-in-law. Without thinking of the consequences, she comes closer to Sunil, betraying her twin sister and family. What happens to her clandestine relationship is the crux of
the story.

Q3. Do you think Amrita's relationship with Sunil is justified? Give reasons.

Ans *The Agony of Win* is a simple short story about a woman who falls for her sister's husband, Sunil. She goes on to have an alleged affair with Sunil, which both of them tries to keep under wraps. However, Amrita is aware that she is not doing the right thing but is completely smitten by the charms of her brother-in-law. Without thinking of the consequences, she comes closer to Sunil, betraying her twin sister and family. What happens to her clandestine relationship is the crux of
the story.



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Q4. How would have Madhu reacted if she comes to know about Amrita and Sunil's alleged affair?
Ans Madhu was firm and she had replied, "Yes it is. Considering your old habits, I am bound to think like that but, let me remind you if you don't mend you ways, I'll have to speak to her." With that, she had barged out of the room, picking up her two-year old son then. And indeed the warning came in like a life threatening disease to Amrita. After just a few days
since the duo left, Madhu had called Amrita. "Enough damage has occurred and I and my family are not in a position to bear another blow, especially if it is from my own sister. So please promise me that you will never share any kind of communication with Sunil from now on."

Q5. What according to you should be the end of the story 'The Agony of Win'? Explain.
Ans According to your point of view˙˙˙˙˙A person is responsible for his or her own happiness, if you depend on others to make you happy, you are probably in for a big surprise. Also, do what you think is right and appropriate for you and what will make you happy. However, your happiness should not become the cause of someone else's misery.

Q6. Describe the condition of modern women and traditional women in the metropolitan cities?
Ans Write down according your point of view˙˙˙˙˙

Q7. Justify the title *The Agony of Win*.
Ans *The Agony of Win* is a simple short story about a woman who falls for her sister's husband, Sunil. She goes on to have an alleged affair with Sunil, which both of them tries to keep under wraps. Though Amrita is aware that she is not doing the right thing but she is completely smitten by the charms of her brother in-law. Without thinking of the consequences, she comes closer to Sunil, betraying her twin sister and family. Sunil's selfish nature is clearly depicted in the scene in which he proclaims that he is a married man with a family to look after. _ When Amrita realised the true nature of Sunil, she decided to end things. This throws the light on the fact that you are responsible for your actions. _ A person is responsible for his or her own happiness, if you depend on others to make you happy, you are probably in for a big surprise.

## UNIT 8: LOVE LIVES BEYOND THE TOMB BY JOHN CLARE

Q1 Explore the ways in which Clare's writing reflects some of the basic principles of Romanticism.
Ans John Clare is usually considered one of the Romantic poets and this is an identification, which he probably would have welcomed. He was an admirer of Byron and a particular fan of Wordsworth, whose work he found "so natural and beautiful" even after, he confessed, expecting to dislike it. Though Clare never really has to know the major Romantics, he moved on the edges of their circle. On his rare visits to London, he met Coleridge on one trip and, in fact, shared Keats's publisher, John Taylor. Clare's poems reflect some of the values and explore many of the themes associated with the Romantic poets though his preoccupations and beliefs are occasionally at odds with theirs. The Romantic poets were passionate about the natural world, seeing in it reflections of the eternal.

Q3. The fusion of pain and pleasure is a key concept in Romantic thinking. How do you feel this is explored in John Clare's poetry?
Ans In his '*The Morning mist is changing blue'*, Clare focuses on a chance meeting with a pretty maid and celebrates the effect this has upon him whereas in '*I dreamt not what is to woo'* Clare adopts the persona of a woman who describes the complexity of the pain and pleasure experienced when uncertainty characterises a relationship. *First Love's Recollections* is characterised by a yearning for what has gone before. Throughout the poem the speaker nostalgically reflects on an



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earlier period in his life when Mary, possibly Mary Joyce, with whom Clare fell in love, a woman who was to become his muse and as he described metaphorically his "second wife", responded to his love and life seemed full of possibilities. In *An Invite to Eternity*, Clare, uncharacteristically, moves away from the natural landscape and sets his poem in a world beyond death. On the other hand, in *Love and Memory*, the speaker remains alive and his ladylove dies. As we know, Mary Joyce died young at the age of 41; it is possible to read this poem as Clare's testament of his loss, and of the pain, he experiences having only memories left to create images of Mary.

Q4. John Clare's writing is characterised by his passion for nature. Consider the ways Clare presents his relationship with nature throughout this collection of poems.
Ans John Clare is usually considered one of the Romantic poets and this is an identification, which he probably would have welcomed. He was an admirer of Byron and a particular fan of Wordsworth, whose work he found "so natural and beautiful" even after, he confessed, expecting to dislike it. Though Clare never really has to know the major Romantics, he moved on the edges of their circle. On his rare visits to London, he met Coleridge on one trip and, in fact, shared Keats's publisher, John Taylor. Clare's poems reflect some of the values and explore many of the themes associated with the Romantic poets though his preoccupations and beliefs are occasionally at odds with theirs. The Romantic poets were passionate about the natural world, seeing in it reflections of the eternal.

Q5. Clare saw himself as a man on the outside of society. Within his writing, how does he explore this sense being an outsider?
Ans The outlook of the child was privileged in Clare as it was in others of the Romantics. His poems frequently feature "noising children" whose enthusiasm for life is portrayed as exemplary – and though his village youths will often rob a nest, they will put in a hard day's work and take pleasure in it. He wrote in his autobiographical sketches that he had found "nothing but poetry about childhood, nothing of poetry about manhood" - a classic Romantic sentiment. Clare's was an unexpectedly complex personality. To an extent, he led something of a fantasy life, visualising himself as a Dick Whittington, the poor boy who rose to fame, not sure, where he fitted in. He had a strong sense of his vocation as a poet and of the mission of poetry itself. His autobiographical writings reveal him as refreshingly honest, sensible, self-deprecating, intelligent and funny, capable of some very sophisticated writing, which was characterised by long, finely turned sentences. He was, by his own admission, scruffy and awkward, often diffident in the presence of strangers, absent-minded and disposed to be easily led and sometimes, he felt, duped. "My whole life has been a first of April," he wrote gloomily in his journal. He confessed that he had a "heated spirit" which inclined him to bursts of temper. Weak health, physical and
later mental, overshadowed his life from birth.

Q7. Critically analyse the poem *Love Lives Beyond the Tomb.*
Ans John Clare's poetry can be difficult for three reasons. "Love Lives Beyond the Tomb" was written after 1860 therefore falls within what Edmund Blunden and Alan Porter, editors of *John Clare: Poems Chiefly from Manuscript,* call the "Asylum Poems" (4-6). This leads to **the first difficulty** with understanding Clare's poems. After a difficult peasant's labouring life and some small financial assistance from his London patrons, Clare's family agreed to have him hospitalized for delusions of having once been Shakespeare and Byron. Poems written during the asylum years may have more challenging structural elements than his earlier poems. This leads to a **second difficulty.** Clare was the son of illiterate peasant farmers from a village of similarly illiterate farmers. He did not receive proper education. Yet his style featured some unorthodox irregularities about punctuation. His publishers changed much of it yet only under the pressure of protests from Clare who viewed the irregularities as the best way to express his ideas; he called these editors the "awkward squad" (Blunden and Porter). This leads to the **third difficulty.** While Clare spoke and



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wrote in the standard contemporary English of the educated, he intentionally maintained elements of his village dialect directly incorporated in his poems or indirectly incorporated through influence on syntax and expressions.

Q8. Write a note on Clare's poems catering to the theme of love.
Ans In his *'The Morning mist is changing blue'*, Clare focuses on a chance meeting with a pretty maid and celebrates the effect this has upon him whereas in *'I dreamt not what is to woo'* Clare adopts the persona of a woman who describes the complexity of the pain and pleasure experienced when uncertainty characterises a relationship. *First Love's Recollections* is characterised by a yearning for what has gone before. Throughout the poem the speaker nostalgically reflects on an earlier period in his life when Mary, possibly Mary Joyce, with whom Clare fell in love, a woman who was to become his muse and as he described metaphorically his "second wife", responded to his love and life seemed full of possibilities. In *An Invite to Eternity*, Clare, uncharacteristically, moves away from the natural landscape and sets his poem in a world beyond death. On the other hand, in *Love and Memory*, the speaker remains alive and his ladylove dies. As we know, Mary Joyce died young at the age of 41; it is possible to read this poem as Clare's testament of his loss, and of the pain, he experiences having only memories left to create images of Mary. *The Spring returns, the pewit screams*, like several others we have encountered, deals with the loss of love and in particular Clare's loss of Mary Joyce whereas *Say what is love* is another short poem that deals with Clare's loss of Mary Joyce. In short rhyming couplets, he traces the pain of loss and attempts to unravel the nature of love. In contrast to some of the sentiments about love, readers have seen in the collection so far, *Love Lives beyond the Tomb* appear to celebrate the enduring nature of love that the speaker asserts lives beyond death.

## UNIT 9: THE TRAVELLER'S STORY OF A TERRIBLY STRANGE BED BY WILKIE COLLINS

Q1. Did you like *The Traveller's Story of a Terribly Strange Bed*? Why or why not?
Ans yes , I like this story that *The Traveller's Story of a Terribly Strange Bed because* Collins created a legacy of enduring characters. He uses the figure of the artist, such as Walter Hartright from The Woman In White, in a variety of ways. He endows Hartright with both masculine and feminine characteristics to make him seem more fallible and real. Walter isable to serve a parental function, providing an outlet for the subconscious to reveal itself. He is a more developed version of a character Collins originally creates in his short story "A Terribly Strange Bed," a tale, which was first published in 1852, eight years before The Woman in White.

Q3. Critically analyse *The Traveller's Story of a Terribly Strange Bed.*
Ans Collins has been called "the father of the English detective novel" and many critics have observed that his principal strength lies in his expert manoeuvring of characters through complex plots. Indeed, he is credited with having influenced Dickens in this area. While Collins has sometimes been criticized for his weak characters, scholars have acknowledged that he nevertheless provided the prototypes for many stock characters that were to people subsequent detective fiction. Sergeant Cuff of *The Moonstone* exhibits characteristics that have shown up in later generations of fictional detectives, and Count Fosco of *The Woman in White* is recognised as the model for the devilishly charming villain. Commentators have also noted that many devices that seem today to be tired clichés—from mistaken identities to cursed jewels—were introduced by Collins. In addition to assessments of Collins's influence on detective fiction, many modern critics have begun the process of examining issues of gender and culture in his gothic and sensation



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novels, noting the way Collins departed from the traditions of popular fiction to create an insightful and subtly critical portrait of Victorian society in his works.

Q5. What did you think of the plot line development? How credible did the author make the plot? Did the plot take turns you did not expect, or did you find it predictable?
Ans The plot line development- Collins has been called "the father of the English detective novel" and many critics have observed that his principal strength lies in his expert manoeuvring of characters through complex plots. Indeed, he is credited with having influenced Dickens in this area. While Collins has sometimes been criticized for his weak characters, scholars have acknowledged that he nevertheless provided the prototypes for many stock characters that were to people subsequent detective fiction. Sergeant Cuff of *The Moonstone* exhibits characteristics that have shown up in later generations of fictional detectives, and Count Fosco of *The Woman in White* is recognised as the model for the devilishly charming villain. Commentators have also noted that many devices that seem today to be tired clichés—from mistaken identities to cursed jewels—were introduced by Collins. In addition to assessments of Collins's influence on detective fiction, many modern critics have begun the process of examining issues of gender and culture in his gothic and sensation novels, noting the way Collins departed from the traditions of popular fiction to create an insightful and subtly critical portrait of Victorian society in his works.

Q6. Did you find the characters believable? Which of the characters did you like the most? Which did you dislike?
Ans There are two main characters like Mr. Faulkner Walter Hartright¸ Both are good but my first prefer goes to Walter Hartright because He expresses himself through characters like Walter Hartright and the artist in "A Terribly Strange Bed."
there are two distinct roles in "A Terribly Strange Bed," that of the artist and that of the storyteller, Mr. Faulkner, the framed narrative technique reveals the artist himself to be a storyteller by relating to the reader the tale Faulkner has told him. He is similar to Walter Hartright, another man who is both visual artist and storyteller. Like Hartright, who possesses the textual body of Anne Catherick, whose story he relates, the artist textually possesses the body of Faulkner, whose story he relates to the reader. The artist also possesses the physical body of Faulkner because he is painting him and manipulating the man so that he will give the artist a natural expression. The artist is an early form of Walter Hartright. Both exert control over others by relating tales. By becoming storytellers, they both assume a position of authority, which they do not experiencein their everyday lives as middle class artists. The storyteller is of the utmost importance to Collins. He expresses himself through characters like Walter Hartright and the artist in "A Terribly Strange Bed." These artist figures embody the artist in Collins himself. He was an artist who used words instead of paint to create a compelling portrait of human character. He reflected the nineteenth century's age of information, by writing novels where documents play a crucial role in the telling of the story.

Q7. Write a note on the writing style of Wilkie Collins.
Ans Wilkie Collins is most notably credited with creating the sensation genre with his novel The Woman in White (1860) and writing the first full-length detective story, The Moonstone (1868). Collins is writing style is characterized by an emphasis on creating a convincing atmosphere of suspense and intrigue. The Woman in White, arguably his most successful work, shows Collins at his peak in terms of plotting and characterization. In *The Woman in White*, Collins borrows key elements from the gothic tradition while updating and innovating the already popular genre. He does this by changing the settings of his stories, moving them from foreign countries, such as France and Italy, to England. He also bombards the reader with documents, reflecting the age of information in which he lived. He takes a somewhat outdated writing style and contemporizes it to his time. In The Woman in White, Collins contemporizes the gothic novel in two important ways.



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The first way is through transgressive gender characterizations. Collins is widely known for creating characters that do not fit into the specific moulds of male and female. His female characters often show masculine resolution and courage in deciphering mysteries within a particular novel. His male characters frequently show a softer, more feminine side whereby they express their innermost emotions as well as exercising feminine intuition. One of the ways in which Collins illustrates his transgressive gender characterizations is through his use of documents within the text of the story itself to indicate one character's textual possession of another.

Q8. Discuss the Collins' other works and his critical appreciation by other literary geniuses.
Ans Collins's works were classified at the time as "sensation novels," a genre seen nowadays as the precursor to detective and suspense fiction. He also wrote penetratingly on the plight of women and on the social and domestic issues of his time. For example, his 1854 *Hide and Seek* contained one of the first portrayals of a deaf character in English literature. As did many writers of his time, Collins published most of his novels as serials in magazines such as Dickens's All the Year Round and was known as a master of the form, creating just the right degree of suspense to keep his audience reading from week to week. Sales of All The Year Round increased when *The Woman in White* followed *A Tale of Two Cities*. Collins enjoyed ten years of great success following publication of The Woman in White in 1859. His next novel, No Name combined social commentary – the absurdity of the law as it applied to children of unmarried parents – with a densely plotted revenge thriller. *The Moonstone*, published in 1868, and the last novel of what is generally regarded as the most successful decade of its author's career. Despite a somewhat cool reception, it was from both Dickens and the critics, a significant return to form and re-established the market value of an author whose success in the competitive Victorian literary marketplace had been waning in the wake of his first "masterpiece." The Woman in White and The Moonstone share an unusual narrative structure, somewhat resembling an epistolary novel, in which different portions of the book have different narrators,each with a distinct narrative voice (Armadale has this to a lesser extent through the correspondence between some characters). The Moonstone, being the most popular of Collins's novels, is considered a precursor to detective fiction, such as Sherlock Holmes. After The Moonstone, Collins's novels contained fewer thriller elements and commentary thatis more social. The subject matter continued to be sensational, but his popularity declined. The poet Algernon Charles Swinburne commented: "What brought good Wilkie's genius nigh perdition?/Some demon whispered—'Wilkie! Have a mission."

## UNIT 10: BEGGARLY HEART BY RABINDRANATH TAGORE

Q1. Write critical analysis of the poem Beggarly Heart.
Ans *Beggarly Heart* is a part of Tagore's masterpiece *Gitanjali*. His love for humanity by enforcing the values of humanity such as peace and harmony overall. Tagore's poetry *Gitanjali* reflects his desperate efforts to see the world to live in peace and harmony in reality. He strives hard and hard to foster the values of humanity and bring the happiness in the land by encouraging the masses to love one another, live in peace and lead a harmonious life full of contentment. Tagore's goal is to channelize the streams of nationalism to the direction of universalism by freeing human soul from all bondage and pettiness of the world and thereby transcending itself into a search for universal love and brotherhood that the Lord provides to the mankind. Tagore chants this little prayer from his heart especially for those who are spiritually challenged and waits with great expectation for a benefitting and satisfying answer from God. When the heart is hard and parched up, make or become dry through intense heat: extremely thirsty, come upon Him with a shower of mercy. When grace is lost from life, come with a burst of song. When tumultuous; very loud or uproarious: excited, confused, or disorderly; work raises its din; a loud, unpleasant, and prolonged noise: (din something into) instil information into (someone) by constant repetition: make a din; on all sides shutting him out from beyond, come to him, his lord of silence, with his



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peace and rest. Before answering anybody's prayer God keeps His silence for reasons unknown. Then at the moment that we least expect, things start moving in a mighty way that will start transforming all areas in our lives and around us. When his beggarly heart, meagre and ungenerous: poverty-stricken, sits crouched. Adopt a position where the knees are bent and the upper body is brought forward and down: (crouch over) bend over to be close to a crouching stance or posture, shut up in a corner, break open the door, his king, and come with the ceremony of a king. When desire blinds the mind with delusion; an idiosyncratic belief or impression that is not in accordance with a generally accepted reality: the action of deluding or being deluded; and dust, God–the Supreme Ultimate–He is the holy one, He is wakeful, come with His light and His thunder. These are the signs that God will reply in a mighty way.

Q2. "Tagore was a great poet". Elaborate your answer.
Ans Rabindranath Thakur, anglicised to Tagore (7 May 1861–7 August 1941), sobriquet Gurudev, was a Bengali polymath who reshaped his region's literature and music. Author of *Gitanjali* and its "profoundly sensitive, fresh and beautiful verse", he became the first non-European to win the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1913. In translation, his poetry was viewed as spiritual and mercurial; however, his "elegant prose and magical poetry" remain largely unknown outside Bengal. Rabindranath Thakur, anglicised to Tagore sobriquet Gurudev, was a Bengali polymath who reshaped his region's literature and music.Tagore modernised Bengali art by spurning rigid classical forms and resisting linguistic strictures. His novels, stories, songs, dance-dramas, and essays spoke to topics political and personal. Tagore was a prolific composer with 2,230 songs to his credit. His songs are known as rabindrasangit ("Tagore Song"), which merges fluidly into his literature, most of which— poems or parts of novels, stories, or plays alike—were lyricised. Tagore influenced sitar maestro Vilayat Khan and sarodiyas Buddhadev Dasgupta and Amjad Ali Khan. At sixty, Tagore took up drawing and painting; successful exhibitions of his many works which made a debut appearance in Paris upon encouragement by artists he met in the south of France—were held throughout Europe. Tagore wrote eight novels and four novellas, among them Chaturanga, Shesher Kobita, Char Odhay, and Noukadubi. Tagore's three-volume Galpaguchchha comprises eighty-four stories that reflect upon the author's surroundings, on modern and fashionable ideas, and on mind puzzles. Tagore's poetic style, which proceeds from a lineage established by 15th- and 16th-century Vaishnava poets, ranges from classical formalism to the comic, visionary, and ecstatic. Tagore opposed imperialism and supported Indian nationalists, and these views were first revealed in Manast, which was mostly composed in his twenties. In *Beggarly Heart*, the poet writes that when the grace from the world and life of the human is lost, he urges the Lord of Peace to fill himself and the world with his eternal peace, which will make everyone's life a harmonious one indeed.

Q3. "Tagore's humanism is visible in his awareness of life's sufferings and problems." Do youagree? Explain.
Ans Tagore's humanism is visible in his awareness of life's sufferings and problems that Tagore despised rote classroom schooling: in "The Parrot's Training", a bird is caged and force-fed textbook pages—to death. Tagore, visiting Santa Barbara in 1917, conceived a new type of university: he sought to "make Santiniketan the connecting thread between India and the world [and] a world centre for the study of humanity somewhere beyond the limits of nation and geography." The school, which he named Visva-Bharati, had its foundation stone laid on 24 December 1918 and inaugurated precisely three years later. Tagore employed a brahmacharya system: gurus gave pupils personal guidance—emotional, intellectual and spiritual. Teaching was often done under trees. He staffed the school, he contributed his Nobel Prize monies, and his duties as steward-mentor at Santiniketan kept him busy: mornings he taught classes; afternoons and evenings, he wrote the students' textbooks. He fundraised widely for the school in Europe and the United States between 1919 and 1921.



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Q4. Analyse Tagore and his major works in diverse fields.
Ans Rabindranath Thakur, anglicised to Tagore (7 May 1861–7 August 1941), sobriquet Gurudev, was a Bengali polymath who reshaped his region's literature and music. Author of *Gitanjali* and its "profoundly sensitive, fresh and beautiful verse", he became the first non-European to win the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1913. In translation, his poetry was viewed as spiritual and mercurial; however, his "elegant prose and magical poetry" remain largely unknown outside Bengal. Tagore introduced new prose and verse forms and the use of colloquial language into Bengali literature, thereby freeing it from traditional models based on classical Sanskrit. He was highly influential in introducing the best of Indian culture to the West and vice versa, and he is generally regarded as the outstanding creative artist of modern South Asia.

**Music**
Tagore was a prolific composer with 2,230 songs to his credit. His songs are known as rabindrasangit ("Tagore Song"), which merges fluidly into his literature, most of which—poems or parts of novels, stories, or plays alike—were lyricised. Influenced by the thumri style of Hindustani music, they ran the entire gamut of human emotion, ranging from his early dirgelike Brahmo devotional hymns to quasi-erotic compositions.

**Paintings**
At sixty, Tagore took up drawing and painting; successful exhibitions of his many works— which made a debut appearance in Paris upon encouragement by artists he met in the south of France—were held throughout Europe. He was likely red-green colour blind, resulting in works that exhibited strange colour schemes and offbeat aesthetics. Tagore was influenced by scrimshaw from northern New Ireland, Haida carvings from British Columbia, and woodcuts by Max Pechstein. His artist's eye for his handwriting was revealed in the simple artistic and rhythmic leitmotifs embellishing the scribbles, cross-outs, and word layouts of his manuscripts. Some of Tagore's lyrics corresponded in a synesthetic sense with particular paintings.

**Novels**
Tagore wrote eight novels and four novellas, among them Chaturanga, Shesher Kobita, Char Odhay, and Noukadubi. Ghare Baire (The Home and the World)—through the lens of the idealistic zamindar protagonist Nikhil—excoriates rising Indian nationalism, terrorism, and religious zeal in the Swadeshi movement; a frank expression of Tagore's conflicted sentiments, it emerged from a 1914 bout of depression. The novel ends in Hindu-Muslim violence and Nikhil's—likely mortal wounding.

**Stories**
Tagore's three-volume Galpaguchchha comprises eighty-four stories that reflect upon the author's surroundings, on modern and fashionable ideas, and on mind puzzles. Tagore associated his earliest stories, such as those of the "Sadhana" period, with an exuberance of vitality and spontaneity; zamindar Tagore's life in Patisar, Shajadpur, Shelaidaha, and other villages cultivated these traits. Seeing the common and the poor, he examined their lives with a depth and feeling singular in Indian literature up to that point. In "The Fruit seller from Kabul", Tagore speaks in first person as a town dweller and novelist imputing exotic perquisites to an Afghan seller.

**Poetry**
Tagore's poetic style, which proceeds from a lineage established by 15th and 16th century Vaishnava poets, ranges from classical formalism to the comic, visionary and ecstatic. He was influenced by the atavistic mysticism of Vyasa and other rishi-authors of the Upanishads, the Bhakti-Sufi mystic Kabir, and Ramprasad Sen. Tagore's most innovative and mature poetry



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embodies his exposure to Bengali rural folk music, which included mystic Baulballads such as those of the bard Lalon, which were rediscovered and popularised again by Tagore.

**Politics**

Tagore opposed imperialism and supported Indian nationalists, and these views were first revealed in Manast, which was mostly composed in his twenties. Evidence produced during the Hindu – German Conspiracy Trial and latter accounts affirm his awareness of the Ghadarites, and stated that he sought the support of Japanese Prime Minister Terauchi Masatake and former Premier Ôkuma Shigenobu. Yet he lampooned the Swadeshi movement; he rebuked it in "The Cult of the Charka", an acrid 1925 essay. He urged the masses to avoid victimology and instead seek self-help and education, and he saw the presence of British administration as a "political symptom of our social disease".

**Santiniketan and Visva-Bharati**

Tagore despised rote classroom schooling: in "The Parrot's Training", a bird is caged and force-fed textbook pages—to death. Tagore, visiting Santa Barbara in 1917, conceived a new type of university: he sought to "make Santiniketan the connecting thread between India and the world [and] a world centre for the study of humanity somewhere beyond the limits of nation and geography." The school, which he named Visva-Bharati, had its foundation stone laid on 24 December 1918 and inaugurated precisely three years later.

Q5. Do you think that Tagore was deeply influenced by the English Romantic poets? Substantiate your answer.

Ans Tagore's poetic style, which proceeds from a lineage established by 15th and 16th century Vaishnava poets, ranges from classical formalism to the comic, visionary and ecstatic. He was influenced by the atavistic mysticism of Vyasa and other rishi-authors of the Upanishads, the Bhakti-Sufi mystic Kabir, and Ramprasad Sen. Tagore's most innovative and mature poetry embodies his exposure to Bengali rural folk music, which included mystic Baulballads such as those of the bard Lalon, which were rediscovered and popularised again by Tagore. They resemble 19th century Kartâbhajâ hymns that emphasise inward divinity and rebellion against bourgeois bhadralok religious and social orthodoxy. During his Shelaidaha years, his poems took on a lyrical voice of the moner manush, the Bâuls' "man within the heart" and Tagore's "life force of his deep recesses", or meditating upon the jeevan devata—the demiurge or the "living God within". This figure connected with divinity through appeal to nature and the emotional interplay of human drama. Such tools saw use in his Bhânusimha poems chronicling the Radha-Krishnaromance, which were repeatedly revised over the course of seventy years.

Q6. Discuss Tagore was a nationalist and an ardent patriot.

Ans "The attempt to evaluate the relationship of Tagore with the phenomenon of nationalism is hardly uncomplicated and defeats easy categorisation, naturally drawing attention as it must, to the porosity of the concept of nationalism. Although it is the received wisdom in many quarters that Tagore unlike Gandhi was opposed to nationalism, a close analysis may reveal why in his obituary of Tagore Gandhi chose to say: 'In the death of Rabindranath Tagore, we have not only lost the greatest poet of the age, but an ardent nationalist who was also a humanitarian'. Was there a nationalist hidden in Tagore which appealed to Gandhi's nationalism? This paper will try to examine Tagore's nationalism and his different understanding of the constituents of the nation – culture, language, history, idea of nationhood, memory, non violence – which led him to occasionally take stances that appeared to strike at the roots of the conventional notion of nation, exploring in parallel the extent to which the category of nationalism can be stretched without becoming something of its opposite. Waismann's idea of open texture, more generally used in the



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philosophy of language, indicates that notwithstanding definitions there still remain possibilities of a definition being inadequate, although being different from vagueness insofar as the definition may be fairly accurate. This paper on the nation of Tagore will look at the open texture of nationalism."

Q7. "Tagore was more a poet of Nature, than of man or God." Analyse the statement.
Ans Nature than of man or god:-Tagore is more a poet of sepration than union.the gamut of "the crescent "is large and tender and a little sophisticated in what a beautiful way the motherless child speaks

"I Cannot remember my mother "
Only something in the midst of play
A tune seems to however my play things
The tune of some song that she used to hum
While rocting the cradle

The poet is of the opinion that god is ot only omnipresent but also the creater of everything and hodwells in the temple of humanbody˛ god is satyam,shivim, sundaram, tagore has even eternized the mood and a moment˛ god is truth that illusion the dark recesses of the poet's mend˛ the poet feels that the true worship of god consists in total indentification with ordinary , suffering mood,irrespective of self and power ˛ tagore's consciousness reminds the purgation and conversion of king lear so the poetidentifies himself with the suffering humanity in order to feel the presence of god˛

Q9. Write a note on the diction used in the poems of Tagore you have read.
Ans Poetic diction is term to refer to the linguistic style , the vocabulary and the metaphors used in the writing of poetry . in the western tradition , all these element s were thought of as properly different in poetry and prose up to the time of the romantic revolution when William wordsworth challenged the distinction in his romantic manifesto, the preface to the second (1800) edition of lyrical ballads(1798). Wordsworth proposed that a "language near to the language of men" was as appropriate for poetry ass it was for prose . this idea was very influential though more in theory than practice . a special "poetic vocabulary and mode of metaphor " persisted in 19$^{th}$ century poetry. It was deplored by the modernist poets of the 20$^{th}$ century,

## UNIT 11: NEXT SUNDAY BY R K NARAYAN

Q1. Write critical analysis on Narayan's writings.
Ans Critics have noted that Narayan's writings tend to be more descriptive and less analytical; the objective style, rooted in a detached spirit, providing for a more authentic and realistic narration. His attitude, coupled with his perception of life, provided a unique ability to fuse characters and actions, and an ability to use ordinary events to create a connection in the mind of the reader. A significant contributor to his writing style was his creation of Malgudi, a stereotypical small town, where the standard norms of superstition and tradition apply. Narayan's writing style was often compared to that of William Faulkner since both their works brought out the humour and energy of ordinary life while displaying compassionate humanism. The similarities also extended to their juxtaposing of the demands of society against the confusions of individuality. Although their approach to subjects was similar, their methods were different; Faulkner was rhetorical and illustrated his points with immense prose while Narayan was very simple and realistic, capturing the elements all the same.

Q2. Describe in detail the theme of *Next Sunday*.



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Ans *Next Sunday* is a collection of weekly essays by R K Narayan published in 1960. The book provides insights into Narayan's writings and perspectives and the protagonists of his works - the middle class common man. The book also includes his reflections on the themes of and actions in his novels and short stories. *Next Sunday* is the first essay in "Writerly Life". Here, R K Narayan says that everyone looks forward to Sunday. It is a day on which there are many things to do. A man plans to do the work of 48 hours that day. He wants to get up late. However, he is disturbed and gets up in a disappointed mood. It is not a good way to start the day. The charm of the day is lost at the very start. By the time he begins his work, the Sunday nearly has gone. He begins to notice the things in the house. He had no time to examine those things on other days. He is a hobbyist. He likes to repair things with his own hand. He wants to hang a picture, repair the radio and oil the watch. He sits like a great god in his workshop. However, he is unable to do anything because he finds many instruments are missing somewhere in the cupboard. The boys of him who stand near him want to escape from their father's scolding. Suddenly he sees his children playing in the next house. He finds that his children are not developing on the right times. He punishes them. The man finds that half the Sunday is left. There are only a few more hours left. He remembers his
promises. He wants to fulfil them. He gets up after his rest. He thinks that he can take his family out on that day. Then he remembers how he spent the previous Sunday with children, howling with hunger at the bus stand. He says to his children to stay at home that day. He promises to take his family out 'the next Sunday'. In "The Crowd", R K Narayan says that he likes Crowd. In a crowd, a man can attain great calmhe can forget himself for a few hours. He has seen many crowds when he is in Madras near radio stand at the Marina, Flower Bazaar road, Central Railway Station platform and Parry's corner to
Moore market. There he was watched humanity in a dazzling variety and shape of colours, forms, voices, appeals and activities. He likes crowd at a temple festival. The misanthrope hates a crowd, misses the charm of life. In the essay "Coffee", the author describes the story of Coffee and the way it came to India. Bababuden, a Muslim saint came from Mocha, bringing with him a handful of seeds and settled himself on the slope of a mountain range in Kadur district, Mysore state. This range was later named after him, and anyone can see his tomb while making a short trip from Chikmangulur.
Later he describes the process of Coffee-making, which everyone does, but he gives many precautions for making tasty Coffee. Thus R K Narayan's early essays cover a range of subjects which are common such as 'Restaurants',
'Gardening without Tears', 'Of Trains and Travellers', etc.

Q3. What is the writing style of Narayan? How this style made him different from other
Ans Narayan's writing style was simple and unpretentious with a natural element of humour about it. It focused on ordinary people, reminding the reader of next-door neighbours, cousins and the like, thereby providing a greater ability to relate to the topic. Unlike his national contemporaries, he was able to write about the intricacies of Indian society without having to modify his characteristic simplicity to conform to trends and fashions in fiction writing. He also employed the use of nuanced dialogic prose with gentle Tamil overtones based on the nature of his characters. Critics have considered Narayan to be the *Indian Chekhov*, due to the similarities in their writings, the simplicity and the gentle beauty and humour in tragic situations. Greene considered Narayan more similar to Chekhov than any Indian writer. Anthony West of *The New Yorker* considered Narayan's writings to be of the realism variety of Nikolai Gogol. writers and helped him gain popularity? this style made him different from other because R K Narayan is the grand old man of Indian fiction. Besides fiction, he was also a good non-fictionalessayist.

Q4. Write a brief biography of Narayan.



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Ans R K Narayan is the grand old man of Indian fiction. Besides fiction, he was also a good non-fictional essayist. That's why he won the first Indian Sahitya Akademi Award. All his books of fiction and non-fiction are excellent and must read by anybody who can read English. His language is very lucid and transparent. He writes for children and adults. His career spanned seven long and illustrious decades from the 1930s to the 1990s. As our study of paper is restricted to only R K Narayan as a non-fictional essayist, it is better to deal with his essays instead of novels and short stories. Almost throughout his career, R K Narayan wrote non-fictional pieces/essays. They were written at various times, which indicated his growth of mind as a writer like William Wordsworth. Starting with pieces written as a weekly contribution to the 'Hindu' in the late 1930s, Narayan's interest in the short form led him to comment, over the next few decades, on just about every aspect of the world around him that held his interest. R K Narayan's novels are like a box of Indian sweets: a highly coloured container conceals a range of delectable treats, all different in a subtle way, but each one clearly from the same place. There are fourteen novels in the oeuvre – enough to create a world. Enthusiasts of his work will read them all and return to them repeatedly.

OR

R K Narayan wrote non-fictional pieces/essays. They were written at various times, which indicated his growth of mind as a writer like William Wordsworth. Next Sunday is a collection of weekly essays by R K Narayan published in 1960. He was born in Madras in 1906 and educated there and at Maharajah's College in Mysore. Narayan experienced rejection with the short stories, which he wrote, although he eventually succeeded in his ambition to get into print abroad when a piece he wrote for Punch magazine in London was accepted and produced a handsome fee of six guineas. Graham Greene played a vital role in Narayan's life as he helped him in publishing his first novel. His writing style was simple and unpretentious with a natural element of humour about it. It focused on ordinary people, reminding the reader of next-door neighbours, cousins
and the like. In "The Crowd", R K Narayan says that he likes Crowd. In a crowd, a man can attain great calm- he can forget himself for a few hours. He has seen many crowds when he is in Madras near radio stand at the Marina, Flower Bazaar road, Central Railway Station platform and Parry's corner to Moore market. In the essay "Coffee", the author describes the story of Coffee and the way it came to India.Bababuden, a Muslim saint came from Mocha, bringing with him a handful of seeds and settled himself on the slope of a mountain range in Kadur district, Mysore state. R K Narayan wrote these essays for 'The Hindu' and other periodicals. They were written when he has at the peak of his career. These pieces represent various aspects of Narayan's engagement with Post-Independence India. His prose essays are ideal to read because of funny, warm-hearted, satirical and yet serious aspects of those essays. The Later Essays are longer than the other two. R K Narayan wrote on the topics that were significant to him. One such essay is 'A Writer's Nightmare' (1988).

Q5. What led Narayan to create a fantasy world, Malgudi? What is its significance?
Ans Malgudi was not just a fictional town in India, but also one teeming with characters, each with their own idiosyncrasies and attitudes, making the situation as familiar to the reader as if it were their own backyard. "Whom next shall I meet in Malgudi? That is the thought that comes to me when I close a novel of Mr Narayan's. I do not wait for another novel. I wait to go out of my door into those loved and shabby streets and see with excitement and a certainty of pleasure a stranger approaching, past the bank, the cinema, the haircutting saloon, a stranger who will greet me I know with some unexpected and revealing phrase that will open a door on to yet another human existence."



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Q7. Narayan's greatest achievement was making India accessible to the outside world through his literature. Elaborate.

Ans Narayan's greatest achievement was making India accessible to the outside world through his literature. He is regarded as one of the three leading English language Indian fiction writers, along with Raja Rao and Mulk Raj Anand. He gave his readers something to look forward to with Malgudi and its residents. It is also considered to be one of the best novelists India has ever produced. He brought small-town India to his audience in a manner that was both believable and experiential. Malgudi was not just a fictional town in India, but also one teeming with characters, each with their own idiosyncrasies and attitudes, making the situation as familiar to the reader as if it were their own backyard. "Whom next shall I meet in Malgudi? That is the thought that comes to me when I close a novel of Mr Narayan's. I do not wait for another novel. I wait to go out of my door into those loved and shabby streets and see with excitement and a certainty of pleasure a stranger approaching, past the bank, the cinema, the haircutting saloon, a stranger who will greet me I know with some unexpected and revealing phrase that will open a door on to yet another human existence."

Q8. Write a note on Narayan as an essayist.

Ans Narayan as an essayist.because R K Narayan's essays have been divided into three sections. The First group of short essays (Earlier Essays) was written over the earlier stages of Narayan's non-fiction carrier from 1930s to 1950s. The second group of short essays (Middle Period Essays) was written from 1950s to 1970s. The third stage of short essays (Later Period Essays) was written 1970s to 1990s. All these essays have been brought together under the rubric 'The World of the Writer'. Narayan wrote these essays during the late 1930s to 1950s for his weekly column in the Hindu. They are all set in the South India of Narayan's early years and showcase his ability to charm etch the characteristics of the world around him. They provide insights into Narayan's protagonists- the middle class common man. They are written in a light-vein. R K Narayan wrote these essays for 'The Hindu' and other periodicals. They were written when he has at the peak of his career. These pieces represent various aspects of Narayan's engagement with Post-Independence India. One such essay is "Reluctant Guru". 'The Newspaper Habit' is a funny essay about the reading habits of a newspaper. The man-in-ahurry
glances at the headings and summary and puts away the paper for a thorough study later in the day but he misses the sports column. The boy, who borrows the paper, detaches the sports page. In the other essay "**The Lost Umbrella**", R K Narayan describes how he often forgets his umbrella at shops, for which he filed a detailed complaint with the police. R K Narayan says that an umbrella is a highly prized possession to anyone. It should be carried carefully without leaving **Notes**
it at any point of the journey. The Later Essays are longer than the other two. R K Narayan wrote on the topics that were
significant to him. One such essay is 'A Writer's Nightmare' (1988).

## UNIT 12: A LICKPENNY LOVER BY O HENRY

**Q**1. List four examples of O Henry's style of writing.

OR

Q2. What literary term applies to O Henry's writing? Cite specific examples from stories which exemplify this term.

OR



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Q8. Write a note on O Henry's other popular works such as *The Gift of Magi*.

Ans Authors of short stories use elements of style to make their stories interesting. There are many literary term applies to O Henry's writing also .There are many elements of style used by authors. Irony and theme are often used in short stories. This is clearly shown in O Henry's short stories such as: "The Gift of the Magi," "The Lickpenny Lover," "The Midsummer Knights Dream," "The Cop and the Anthem" and "Ships." The short stories of O Henry use the element of theme to bring about ironic endings.

**Four examples of O Henry's style of writing.**

1. In "The Gift of the Magi", there are elements of theme throughout the entire story. One example of theme in the story is that poverty affected both the main characters Jim and Della. Jim and Della both lived in a poor neighbourhood with very little money. They both wanted to get each other a very meaningful Christmas present. Another element of theme in this story is that Jim and Della realize how much they love each other. Eugene Garcia fines that "In this trite little tale of mutual self-sacrifice between husband and wife, O Henry crystallized dramatically what the world in all its stored up wisdom knows to be of fundamental value in ordinary family life"(short story criticisms 192). The theme of this story should always be kept in mind that love is more important than money. His works are fully of literary and classical allusions that are never heavy or obtuse and everthoroughly American in their humour and assurance.

2.The short story "A Lickpenny Lover" had a similar theme to "The Gift of the Magi." The reoccurring theme in "A Lickpenny Lover" was that money was not everything. Masie is a young shop girl who is attractive and hardworking. Irving Carter a millionaire asks Masie on a date. He had tried to impress her with his money. Instead, Masie did not think of Carter as a different person because of the money he had. She still saw him as a regular man who asked her on a date. Masie saw Carter as a wealthy man who did not like to use his money. Masie on the other hand did not like him more instead, she liked him less for not being more generous with it.

3 "The Midsummer Night's Dream" is that Mary married for love and not for money. This is shown throughout the entire story by the letter that Marry wrote to her husband describing how much she had missed him. Garcia points out that in the story "There is a contrast between Gaines dream of his courtship days in a mountain resort and the letter he receives from his wife as he sits sweating in a hot office building". Gaines is in the office rather than in the country because he cannot afford it. He knows his wife enjoys it so he saves up to send her there. Since Gaines could not have, what he wanted he made it less important to him. An example of this occurs when he is saying that he "hates the country in the summer and that the city is a much nicer resort". He only says this because he is unable to go there.

4 In the story "The Cop and the Anthem" the ironic element, which is shown, is that when Soapy is ready to change he got what he originally wanted which was to get arrested and go to jail. Ironically, Soapy was in a church when he had decided to change his mind about his direction of his life. Then all of a sudden, a policeman had arrested him for trespassing and gave him six months in jail. Soapy had been arrested unintentionally, when at first he wanted to be arrested. He finally got what he really wanted, which was to go to jail, to eat and have a place to live for six months. This proves that a person who wants to change cannot always have the power to do it at that particular moment. In order to change it usually takes time; Soapy had found it out the hard way.

Elements of style are important devices in helping authors put great emphasis on important issues in their stories. It also helps prove an author's point while writing a story. This is shown



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throughout many of O Henrys short stories by the example of poverty. O Henry has put great emphasis on the two important elements of style in his short stories, which is theme and irony. In the stories written by O Henry, many of them have shown different examples how the element of theme came to bring about ironic endings. O Henry use the element of theme to bring about ironic endings.

Q3. What happened to O Henry that had an effect on his writing? In what ways did this affect his writing?
Ans He is proof of every aspect of the
American dream – a self-educated man, jack of all trades, inhibiter of all frontiers, he lived the stories he so ingeniously crafted. Even the tragedies of his life have the glint of Romance: he fled to South American from accusations of embezzlement, returning later to certain imprisonment to comfort his beloved wife as she succumbed to tuberculosis. Thoroughly American, however, Porter did not buckle under his grief or his incarceration. He rebuilt his writing career from the confines of his Texas cell under the pseudonym of O Henry, a name which rapidly became synonymous with excellence in short stories, with the American spirit, with the vivacious, expanding, and progressing age of the late 19th century in which he worked and lived.

.Q4. Critically analyse *A Lickpenny Lover*.
Ans Critically analyse *A Lickpenny Lover*-There were 2,000 girls in the Biggest Store. Masie was one of them. She was eighteen and a saleslady in the gents' gloves. Here she became versed in two varieties of human beings – the kind of gents who buy their gloves in department stores and the kind of women who buy gloves for unfortunate gents. Besides this wide knowledge of the human species, Masie had acquired other information. She had listened to the promulgated wisdom of the 1,999 other girls and had
stored it in a brain that was as secretive and wary as that of a Maltese cat. Perhaps nature, foreseeing that she would lack wise counsellors, had mingled the saving ingredient of shrewdness along with her beauty, as she has endowed the silver fox of the priceless fur above the other animals with cunning. For Masie was beautiful. A deep-tanned blonde, with the calm poise of a lady who cooks butter cakes in a window. She stood behind her counter in the Biggest Store; and as you closed your hand over the tape-line for your glove measure you thought of Hebe; and as you looked again you wondered how she had come by Minerva's eyes. The basic theme of the story is the connection between being wealthy and being in love.
An authoritative respectable 29 year - old man named Irving Carter by chance happens to drop into the Biggest Store and from the first sight falls in love in a beautiful young saleslady Masie, who is only 18. They seem to be people of quite different circles of society, with different ideas, interests and plans for the future. Still, the author represents a detailed description of both main characters and emphasizes on some features of their personalities with the help of a great
number of stylistic devices.

Q5. Analyse the writing style and themes in O Henry's works.
Ans Authors of short stories use elements of style to make their stories interesting. There are many elements of style used by authors. Irony and theme are often used in short stories. This is clearly shown in O Henry's short stories such as: "The Gift of the Magi," "The Lickpenny Lover," "The Midsummer Knights Dream," "The Cop and the Anthem" and "Ships." The short stories of O Henry use the element of theme to bring about ironic endings.
In "The Gift of the Magi", there are elements of theme throughout the entire story. One example of theme in the story is that poverty affected both the main characters Jim and Della. Jim and Della both lived in a poor neighbourhood with very little money. They both wanted to get each other a very meaningful Christmas present. Another element of theme in this story is that Jim and Della realize how much they love each other. Eugene Garcia fines that "In this trite little tale of mutual



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self-sacrifice between husband and wife, O Henry crystallized dramatically what the world in all its stored up wisdom knows to be of fundamental value in ordinary family life". The theme of this story should always be kept in mind that love is more
important than money. Another example of an element of style is irony. Each person selling something valuable to them shows irony in "The Gift of the Magi". Della had only saved up one dollar and eighty-seven cents to get Jim a Christmas present. Since she did not have enough money she went to a store and sold her hair. Jim at the same time went to a store to sell his watch for money for Della. They both got each other gifts with the money they had gotten from selling their items. The gifts that they sold each had something to do with what they had gotten each other. Della had gotten Jim a medallion for his watch, while Jim had gotten Della beautiful combs for her hair. Arthur Voss finds that it is ironic in "O Henry's famous story of the young married couple, each of whom sells a treasured possession to obtain money to buy a Christmas present for the other". The ironic conclusion of the story is that both Della and Jim were unable to use the gifts they had gotten each other. The short story "A Lickpenny Lover" had a similar theme to "The Gift of the Magi." The reoccurring theme in "A Lickpenny Lover" was that money was not everything. Masie is a young shop girl who is attractive and hardworking. Irving Carter a millionaire asks Masie on a date. He had tried to impress her with his money. Instead, Masie did not think of Carter as a different person because of the money he had. She still saw him as a regular man who asked her on a date. Masie saw Carter as a wealthy man who did not like to use his money. Masie on the other hand did not like him more instead, she liked him less for not being more generous with it. Irony had played a big role in the story "A Lickpenny Lover." One example of irony that occurs often was the misunderstanding of honest love. Garcia stated that in the story "Maize is incapable of knowing honest love from dishonest, and she is in consequence one of his least interesting women" . When Masie was asked by Carter to get married, she did not take him seriously. Garcia thought that "Masie even with her eyes open, rejects, her wealthy suitor because she thinks that his promise to take her to faraway places only means that he wanted her to marry him and go down to Coney island for a wedding tour". Masie only thought that Carter was using a come on line towards her. This just shows how ignorant masie was when judging Carter for being cheap, when he really was planning to take her to Europe. The Theme that is identified in the story "The Midsummer Night's Dream" is that Mary married for love and not for money. This is shown throughout the entire story by the letter that Marry wrote to her husband describing how much she had missed him. Garcia points out that in the story "There is a contrast between Gaines dream of his courtship days in a mountain resort and the letter he receives from his wife as he sits sweating in a hot office building". Gaines is in the office rather than in the country because he cannot afford it. He knows his wife enjoys it so he saves up to send her there. Since Gaines could not have, what he wanted he made it less important to him. An example of this occurs when he is saying that he "hates the country in the summer and that the city is a much nicer resort". He only says this because he is unable to go there.

The irony in "The Midsummer Knight's Dream" is that Gaines really liked the country and missed it. Gaines missed the country because he used to enjoy fishing, but now since he cannot go to the country he says he does not miss fishing. He only stayed in the city because could not afford to go to the country. Gaines decided to make the best of the situation by saying that the city was the best summer resort in the world to his assistant Adkins. Adkins could not understand that Gaines felt this way because he was unable to have something he wanted. He was used to getting what he wanted and a perfect example of this was his wife Mary. Another story "The Cop and the Anthem" has shown a similar theme throughout the story. An important lesson learned in this story is that if you wish for something bad enough it might just come true. The main character of Soapy shows this. Donald Peel finds that in this story "in which a hobo tries unsuccessfully to get arrested so that he can get food and shelter and then is arrested after he decides that he will give up his vagabond ways" (The American Consciousness 230). This shows that Soapy could not change because of the circumstances that surrounded him.



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He really wanted to change for the better, but he was unable to because he was homeless and had a poor look about him. In the story "The Cop and the Anthem" the ironic element, which is shown, is that when Soapy is ready to change he got what he originally wanted which was to get arrested and go to jail. Ironically, Soapy was in a church when he had decided to change his mind about his direction of his life. Then all of a sudden, a policeman had arrested him for trespassing and gave him six months in jail. Soapy had been arrested unintentionally, when at first he wanted to be arrested. He finally got what he really wanted, which was to go to jail, to eat and have a place to live for six months. This proves that a person who wants to change cannot always have the power to do it at that particular moment. In order to change it usually takes time; Soapy had found it out the hard way. In the story "Ships", an example of theme is how the main character Johnny tries to overcome
his poverty and change his position in life. He devises a plan to get rich quick for himself and the shop owner Mr. Hemstetter. Kent Bales explains that "In order to sell shoes, for example, a character imports cockleburs into the near paradise of Anchuria, O Henry's fictional Honduras"(American Writers Supplement 409). The cockleburs were at one point not selling to anyone and Johnny was losing money. O Henry would use made up places in his writings to help develop the theme as he did in "Ships". Therefore, that is why he had chosen a poor fictitious country in Central America. He shows how this can possibly happen in real life to people who want to get rich. The Irony in the "Ships" is that Johnny who is poor and the factory owner, who is also poor soon, become rich in a short amount of time. When a company carrying cockleburs come to the island looking to sell them. The factories owner buys them, and then realizes no one is going to buy them. Bales states that "The enterprising exporter of the original barrel of cockleburs shows up with two ships full of the no longer necessary seeds, expecting to sell them to the factory he **Notes** imagines must somehow use them"(American Writers Supplement). Johnny and the factory owner pout the cockleburs down on the beach. They put them down on the beach in order for people to buy shoes. After they make a lot of money, Johnny leaves the island. The person who grows the cockleburs now was stuck with much too many of them. Johnny now out of the country, because he realized that there was no more demand of shoes so he got out while he still would make money. Now everybody in the country had shoes to walk around in so there feet
would not hurt.

Q7. Give a stylistic analysis of *A Lickpenny Lover*.
Ans stylistic analysis of *A Lickpenny Lover* -The extract under consideration comes from a collection of the short stories "The Voice of the City" written by a prominent American writer O Henry (William Sydney Porter). The book was firstly adopted in 1908 and contain many other stories - "A Comedy in Rubber", "One Thousand Dollars", "The Shocks of Doom", "Roses, Ruses and Romance", etc. All pieces of literature created by this famous writer reveal his extraordinary style of writing. O Henry's short stories are known for their wit, wordplay, warm characterization and clever twist endings. In his day he was called the American answer to Guy de Maupassant. Both authors wrote plot win unexpected endings, but stories by O Henry were much more playful. Besides, his stories are also known for witty narration. This prominent writer wrote primarily about his own time - the early 20th century. Most stories were set in New York and the characters were ordinary people. His brilliant writing style and his optimistic and often playful tone make O Henry's stories a delight to read. From the point of view of presentation the story I have chosen is an extraordinary mixture of the 1st, 2nd and 3rd person narration: "That is the shop girl smile, and I enjoin you to shun it unless you are well fortified with callosity of the heart, caramels and a congeniality for the capers of Cupid."
"She stood behind her counter in the Biggest Store; and as you closed your band over the tape - line for your glove measure you thought of Hebe; and as you looked again you wondered how she had come by Minerva's eyes". "His words penetrated the heart whose very lightness was its armour. She looked up at him with eyes that saw. And a warm glow visited her cool cheeks..." It is



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not clearly known who is the narrator of the story, but seems like it is the author by himself. As an observer of the events, O Henry gives a detailed description of the main characters, their feelings and actions both directly and indirectly: "There were 3,000 girls in the Biggest Store. Masie was one of them. She was eighteen and a
saleslady in the gent's gloves."

"Will you please pardon me", he says, "if I seem too bold, but I earnestly hope you will allow me the pleasure of seeing you again."

"As Carter glided away from the Biggest Store with his mother in his electric runabout, he bit his lip with a dull pain at his heart. He knew that love come to him for the first time in all the 29 years of his life."

The basic theme of the story is the connection between being wealthy and being in love. An authoritative respectable 29 year - old man named Irving Carter by chance happens to drop into the Biggest Store and from the first sight falls in love in a beautiful young saleslady Masie, who is only 18. They seem to be people of quite different circles of society, with different ideas, interests and plans for the future. Still, the author represents a detailed description of both main characters and emphasizes on some features of their personalities with the help of a great number of stylistic devices. At the end of the story when both Masie and Carter are sure that they are a perfect couple, the young girl is shown from a bit different side. She criticizes her man for being naive and greedy when discussing Carter with her friend Lulu in a store. The point is that Irving has an intention to marry her and take abroad, but Masie seems to understand him in a wrong way and believes that he is a poor liar:

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